CONFOEDERATIO,
RESEARCH DIVISION (CRD).

DEMOGRAPHIC AND SETTLEMENT HISTORY OF THE SOVIET UNION UNDER LENIN AND STALIN.

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (1922AD - 1953AD).

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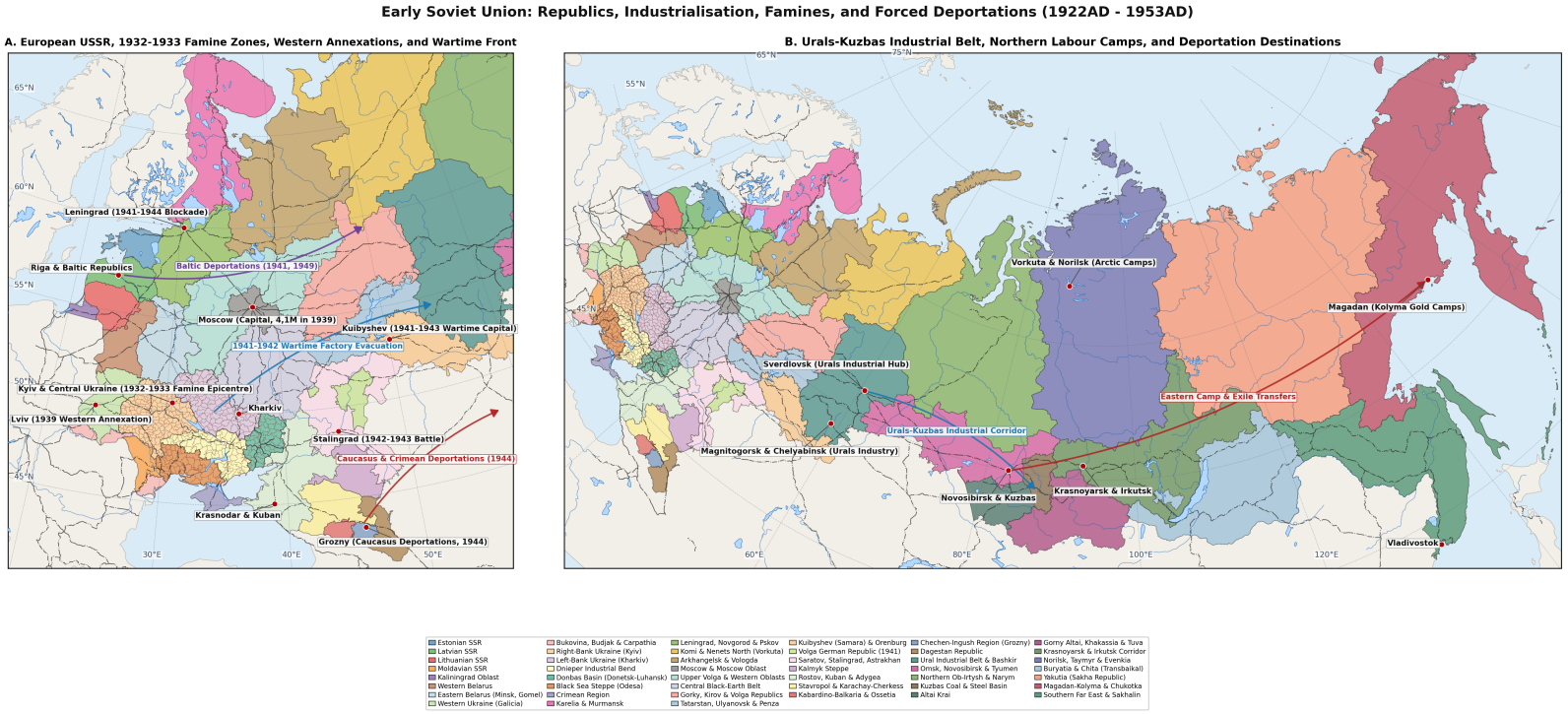


Figure 1. Administrative regions, collectivisation famines, wartime evacuations and forced deportations across the Soviet Union (1926AD - 1953AD).

Abstract

This paper reconstructs the regional population and settlement history of the European and Asian Soviet Union (excluding Transcaucasia and Central Asia) across forty-five regions (n=45) spanning 18.177.917 km2 and eleven benchmark years (n=11) between the First All-Union Census of December 1926AD and the death of Joseph Stalin in March 1953AD. Over this twenty-seven-year period, the population of the forty-five regions rose from 145,07M in 1926AD to a pre-famine peak of 153,85M in 1930AD, fell to 149,93M during the 1932-1933AD famines, recovered to 157,31M in 1937AD, 166,2M in 1939AD and 172,58M in June 1941AD, plunged to 142,62M in 1945AD after the Second World War, and reached 165,35M in March 1953AD.

Background

Between the First All-Union Census of 17 December 1926AD and the death of Joseph Stalin on 5 March 1953AD, the territories of the Russian SFSR (including Kaliningrad Oblast from 1945AD and the Karelo-Finnish SSR from 1940AD to 1956AD), the Ukrainian SSR, the Byelorussian SSR, the Estonian, Latvian and Lithuanian SSRs, and the Moldavian SSR experienced the most violent demographic convulsions, forced population movements and ethno-territorial restructurings in modern Eurasian history [1][2][3][4]. Over twenty-seven years, the population of these forty-five regions (n=45) was reshaped by seven interlocking shocks.

Forced collectivisation and dekulakisation between 1929AD and 1933AD began the upheaval through the expropriation and freight-train exile of 1.803.392 peasants (381.026 families in 1930-1931AD, rising to ~2,1M by 1933AD) as special settlers (*spetspereselentsy*) into northern, Ural and Siberian forestry, mining and taiga clearings (archived PDF; archived PDF) [5][6][7]. Close on the heels of dekulakisation came the man-made famines of 1932-1933AD across Ukraine, the Moldavian ASSR, the Kuban and the Volga, which inflicted direct famine mortality of 3,5M to 3,94M in the Ukrainian SSR and Moldavian ASSR (4,53M including lost births) and ~2,63M across the Russian SFSR in the Kuban, Don, Lower and Middle Volga, Volga German ASSR and Central Black-Earth Belt (archived PDF; archived PDF) [8][9][10][11]. Between 1935AD and 1938AD, pre-war border cleansings and the Great Terror followed, as the NKVD expelled Poles, Germans and Ingrian Finns from western border zones, deported all 171.781 Soviet Koreans from Primorye (Region 45) in autumn 1937AD, and executed ~681.692 persons during the 1937-1938AD *Yezhovshchina* and national operations [4][12][13].

Throughout the entire period from 1928AD to 1953AD, Five-Year-Plan industrialisation and the expansion of the Gulag transferred more than 25M rural inhabitants into heavy-industrial cities (Regions 12, 13, 17, 20, 23-25, 34, 35 and 37) while colonising the Arctic, sub-Arctic and Far East with forced-labour camp complexes (*Belbaltlag*, *Vorkutlag*, *Ukhtpechlag*, *Dmitlag*, *Siblag*, *Norillag*, *Ozerlag*, *Bamlag* and *Dalstroy*/*Sevvostlag* across Regions 16, 18, 20, 36, 37 and 40-45) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [14][15][16]. Under the Molotov-Ribbentrop Pact of 1939-1940AD, the Soviet Union annexed Western Belarus (Region 6), Galicia-Volhynia (Region 8), Finnish Karelia (Region 16), Bessarabia and Northern Bukovina (Regions 4 and 9), and the Estonian, Latvian and Lithuanian SSRs (Regions 1-3); these border changes were accompanied by the 1939-1941AD *Umsiedlung* of ~215k Baltic and Bessarabian Germans and the June 1941AD NKVD deportations (archived PDF; archived PDF) [17][18][19][20].

During the Great Patriotic War (1941-1945AD), total wartime losses reached 26,6M to 27M across the USSR, encompassing the Holocaust of ~2,5M to 2,7M Jews across the occupied Soviet republics (including Ponary, the Ninth Fort, Rumbula, Minsk, Babyn Yar and Transnistria), the 872-day Siege of Leningrad (Region 17), mass eastward factory and civilian evacuations, and the 1941-1944AD liquidation and deportation of the Volga German ASSR (Region 26), Karachay AO (Region 30), Kalmyk ASSR (Region 28), Chechen-Ingush ASSR (Region 32), Balkar districts (Region 31) and Crimean ASSR (Region 15) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [21][22][23][24]. Finally, between 1945AD and 1953AD, post-war expulsions replaced the pre-war populations of Kaliningrad Oblast (Region 5) and South Sakhalin (Region 45), Polish-Ukrainian-Lithuanian population transfers reshaped the western borderlands amid anti-Soviet partisan wars in Lithuania, Latvia, Estonia and Western Ukraine, the 1946-1947AD famine struck Moldavia (Region 4), Ukraine and the Russian Black-Earth zone, and the 1948-1951AD mass collectivisation deportations (Operations *Vesna*, *Priboi*, *Yug* and *Osen*) swept the Baltic and Moldavian SSRs (archived PDF; archived PDF) [25][26][27][28].

Methodology

To avoid anachronistic post-1991AD administrative boundaries and trace the territorial footprint of Stalinist demographic policy, this review divides the European and Asian USSR (excluding Transcaucasia and Central Asia, which are covered in their respective regional series) into forty-five regions (n=45) spanning 18.177.917 km2 across eleven benchmark years (n=11: 1926, 1930, 1933, 1937, 1939, 1941, 1943, 1945, 1947, 1950 and 1953) [1][2][29][30].

Published in fifty-six volumes (n=56) under Vasiliy Mikhaylovsky (TsSU SSSR), the First All-Union Census of 17 December 1926AD enumerated 147,03M inhabitants across the interwar USSR, including 92,74M in the RSFSR, 29,02M in the UkSSR (with 572k in the Moldavian ASSR) and 4,98M in the BSSR [31]. Within our constant 1953AD outer envelope of 45 regions - which excludes interwar Congress Poland and mainland Finland covered in the preceding 1917-1926AD epoch at 167,78M, while incorporating the 1926AD baselines of Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania, Bessarabia, Northern East Prussia/Kaliningrad, Galicia-Volhynia, Northern Bukovina, Transcarpathia, Finnish Viipuri/Karelia, Tannu-Tuva and Southern Sakhalin - the 1926AD population stood at 145,07M. This total comprised 5,62M across the three Baltic republics (1,11M in Estonia Region 1, 1,86M in Latvia Region 2 and 2,65M in Lithuania Region 3), 2,04M in Moldavia Region 4 (Bessarabia plus left-bank MASSR), 7,18M in Belarus Regions 6-7, 36,7M in Ukraine and Crimea Regions 8-15, and 93,53M in Russia, Karelia and Kaliningrad (1,12M in Northern East Prussia Region 5 and 92,41M across Regions 16-45). High late-NEP natural increase subsequently raised the 45-region total to a pre-famine peak of 153,85M in 1930AD.

Collectivisation and the 1932-1933AD famines reduced the 45-region population by -3,91M between 1930AD and 1933AD to a trough of 149,93M, distributed across 5,87M in the Baltic states, 2,19M in Moldavia (where MASSR famine losses were offset by interwar growth in Romanian Bessarabia), 7,7M in Belarus, 35,35M in Ukraine and Crimea (a net fall of -3,65M driven by a loss of -3,9M across Soviet Ukrainian Regions 10-14) and 98,82M in Russia, Karelia and Kaliningrad [8][10]. When the one-day *de facto* All-Union Census of 6 January 1937AD recorded only 162,04M across the USSR (~8M below Stalin's proclaimed target), the Sovnarkom declared the census "wrecked", executed or imprisoned its statistical leadership (I. A. Kraval, O. A. Kvitkin, M. V. Kurman and L. S. Brandgendler), and locked the returns in the Russian State Archive of the Economy (RGAE Fond 1562, Opis 329) until 1989-1991AD (archived PDF) [29][32][33]. Across the 45 regions, the 1937AD population stood at 157,31M.

Declassified audits of the 17 January 1939AD census (170,56M official USSR total) by Andreev, Darsky and Kharkova (1993, 1998) revealed a central statistical inflation (*pripiska*) of 1,7M to 2,9M and a covert redistribution of ~760k to 850k NKVD camp inmates from northern and Siberian Gulag regions (Regions 16, 18, 36, 37 and 40-45) to rural districts of Ukraine and Kazakhstan in order to conceal both Gulag concentrations and 1933AD famine deficits (archived PDF; archived PDF) [1][30][34][35]. Harmonised across all 45 regions, the population reached 166,2M in 1939AD and peaked in June 1941AD at 172,58M, comprising 5,99M in the Baltic SSRs after the 1939-1941AD Baltic German *Umsiedlung* and 14 June 1941AD deportations, 2,47M in the Moldavian SSR, 8,8M in the Byelorussian SSR, 41,56M in the Ukrainian SSR including Crimea, and 113,75M in Russia, Karelia and East Prussia.

German and Romanian occupation, combat mortality, the Holocaust, urban sieges, wartime flight and the 1941-1944AD ethnic deportations depressed the 45-region total to 146,48M in 1943AD and 142,62M in 1945AD, a decline of -29,96M (-17,4%) below June 1941AD (4,89M in the Baltic SSRs, 2,08M in the Moldavian SSR, 180k in Kaliningrad Oblast, 6,3M in Belarus, 30,15M in Ukraine and Crimea, and 99,02M across Regions 16-45) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [36][37]. Checked by the 1946-1947AD famine (146,24M in 1947AD, when the Moldavian SSR fell to its 1,94M famine trough) and the 1947-1951AD western deportations, post-war demobilisation and industrial reconstruction carried the 45 regions to 156,53M in 1950AD and 165,35M in March 1953AD (5,78M in the Baltic SSRs, 2,52M in the Moldavian SSR,

7,2M in the Byelorussian SSR, 35,48M in the Ukrainian SSR including Crimea, and 114,37M in the RSFSR including 540k in Kaliningrad and 1,12M in the Karelo-Finnish SSR), splicing at 165,35M with the subsequent post-Stalin (1953AD - 1991AD) epoch.

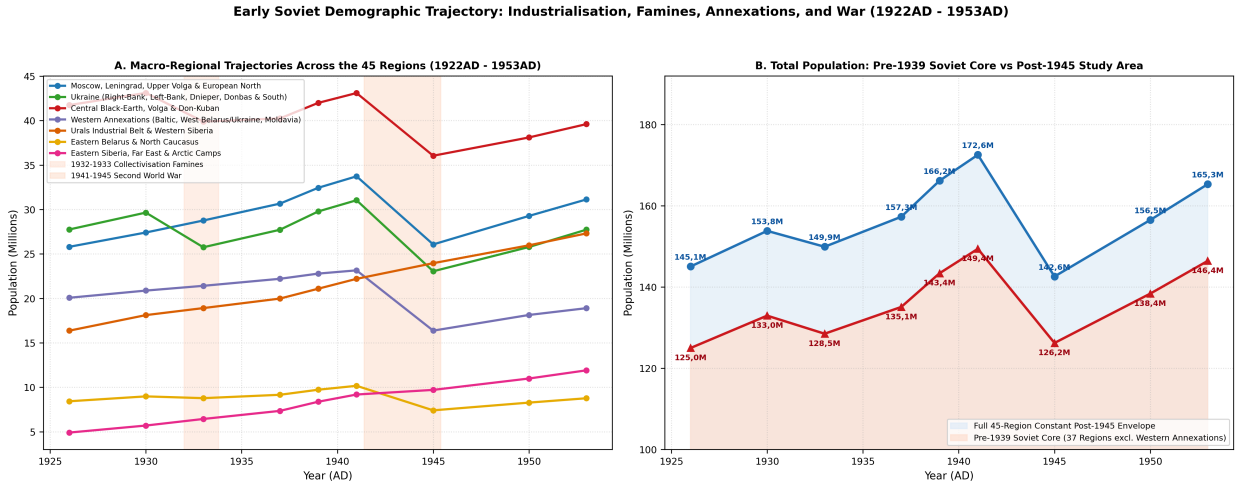


Figure 2. Regional and union-republic population trajectories across the forty-five Soviet demographic regions from 1926AD to 1953AD.

Results

Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
1. Estonian SSR (1940 Occup., 1941/49 Priboi & Oil-Shale Inflow)	1,11M	1,12M	1,12M	1,13M	1,05M	960k	854k	1,15M
2. Latvian SSR (1940 Occup., Shoah, Courland & 1949 Priboi)	1,86M	1,9M	1,93M	2M	1,91M	1,74M	1,58M	2,01M
3. Lithuanian SSR (1939 Vilnius, Shoah, LLKS & 1948-51 Exiles)	2,64M	2,74M	2,82M	2,98M	3,03M	2,68M	2,46M	2,62M

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
4. Moldavian SSR (MASSR + 1940 Bessarabia, 1947 Famine & Op. Yug)	2,04M	2,14M	2,19M	2,41M	2,47M	2,12M	2,08M	2,52M
5. Kaliningrad Oblast (1945 Potsdam, German Expulsion & Settlers)	1,12M	1,14M	1,16M	1,21M	1,22M	1,15M	180k	540k
6. Western Belarus (1939 Annex.: Brest, Grodno, Baranavichy)	2,34M	2,49M	2,59M	2,82M	2,95M	2,28M	2,12M	2,31M
7. Eastern Byelorussian SSR (Minsk, Vitebsk, Mogilev, Gomel)	4,84M	5,16M	5,11M	5,58M	5,85M	4,22M	4,18M	4,89M
8. Western Ukraine: Galicia & Volhynia (1939 Annex., Shoah & UPA)	6,59M	6,88M	7,08M	7,55M	7,74M	5,95M	5,18M	5,66M
9. N. Bukovina & Budjak (1940) + Tran-scarpathia (1945 Annex.)	2,36M	2,47M	2,52M	2,69M	2,78M	2,25M	1,92M	2,09M
10. Right-Bank UkSSR (Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Cherkasy Holodomor)	8,22M	8,56M	7,01M	7,59M	7,88M	6,14M	5,95M	6,63M

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
11. Left-Bank UkSSR (Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy, Chernihiv Holodomor)	9,6M	9,95M	8,15M	8,75M	8,95M	6,85M	6,75M	7,45M
12. Dnieper Industrial Bend (Dnipropetrovsk, Zaporizhzhia, Kryvyi Rih)	3,65M	3,95M	3,55M	4,45M	4,68M	3,45M	3,55M	4,38M
13. Donbas Coal-Steel Basin (Stalino/ Donetsk & Voroshilov-grad/ Luhansk)	2,98M	3,65M	3,85M	4,98M	5,32M	3,45M	3,85M	5,42M
14. Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe (Odesa, Mykolaiv, Kherson)	2,65M	2,79M	2,44M	2,89M	3,03M	2,36M	2,35M	2,87M
15. Crimean ASSR to Oblast (May 1944 Deportation of 191k Tatars)	650k	750k	750k	1,12M	1,18M	750k	600k	980k
16. Karelo-Finnish SSR (1940-56: Vyborg, 422k Evacuees, BBK) & Murmansk	860k	980k	1,12M	1,39M	1,12M	820k	680k	1,12M

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
17. Leningrad Siege Metropolis, Novgorod & Pskov Oblasts (1941-44)	4,69M	5,18M	5,52M	6,3M	6,96M	3,03M	4,34M	5,49M
18. Komi ASSR (1936: Vorkutlag, Intalag, Ukhtpechlag) & Nenets Okrug	240k	280k	340k	430k	490k	540k	560k	750k
19. Northern Forestry & Kulak Exile Belt: Arkhangelsk & Vologda	2,28M	2,47M	2,61M	2,82M	2,93M	2,61M	2,49M	2,93M
20. Moscow Metropolis & Moscow Oblast (Metro, Dmitlag Canal & Hub)	4,57M	5,45M	6,35M	8,45M	8,95M	7,45M	8,15M	10,05M
21. Upper Volga & Western Front (Kalinin, Smolensk, Bryansk, Volgolag)	13,16M	13,05M	12,82M	13,05M	13,28M	10,15M	9,85M	10,79M
22. Central Black-Earth Belt (Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Tambov, Tula)	14,05M	14,35M	13,45M	13,65M	13,85M	10,45M	10,35M	11,15M

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
23. Chuvash, Mari, Mordovian (Temlag) & Udmurt ASSRs + Gorky/Kirov	6,77M	6,98M	6,88M	7,15M	7,28M	6,95M	6,68M	6,95M
24. Tatar ASSR & Ulyanovsk-Penza Middle Volga	5,21M	5,35M	5,15M	5,38M	5,52M	5,25M	5,02M	5,22M
25. Kuibyshev (1941-43 Wartime Capital) & Chkalov (Orenburg)	3,65M	3,85M	3,65M	3,95M	4,15M	4,45M	4,15M	4,68M
26. Volga German ASSR (Liquidated Aug 1941: 438k Germans Deported)	572k	600k	480k	606k	620k	210k	250k	340k
27. Saratov, Stalingrad (1942-43 Battle Ruin) & Astrakhan Lower Volga	4,24M	4,4M	3,84M	4,09M	4,25M	3,38M	3,43M	4,04M
28. Kalmyk ASSR (Liquidated Dec 1943 Op. Ulusy: 93,1k Deported)	140k	160k	150k	180k	185k	140k	65k	100k
29. Rostov, Krasnodar (1932-33 Kuban Blacklisted Stanitsas) & Adygei AO	7,11M	7,42M	6,28M	6,98M	7,24M	5,92M	6,1M	7,12M

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
30. Stavropol Krai, Karachay AO (Nov 1943 Deport. 69,3k) & Cherkess AO	1,61M	1,7M	1,52M	1,67M	1,74M	1,43M	1,45M	1,7M
31. Kabardino-Balkar ASSR (Mar 1944 Deport. 37,7k) & N. Ossetian ASSR	680k	740k	760k	890k	930k	820k	760k	930k
32. Chechen-Ingush ASSR to Grozny Oblast (Feb 1944 Op. Chechevitsa: 493,3k)	590k	640k	650k	760k	790k	710k	340k	490k
33. Dagestan ASSR (1944 Aukhovsky Chechen Deport. & Mountain Transfers)	710k	740k	740k	830k	860k	720k	680k	760k
34. Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR (Sverdlovsk, Tankograd, Magnito-gorsk)	9,1M	9,95M	10,25M	11,35M	11,9M	13,5M	12,75M	14,39M
35. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine (Tyumen, Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk)	3,88M	4,22M	4,34M	4,82M	5,08M	5,88M	5,55M	6,34M

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
36. Ob-Irtysh Special-Settlement Taiga (Narym/ Nazino, Yugra & Yamal)	360k	480k	620k	680k	720k	790k	750k	820k
37. Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag (Kemerovo 1943: Stalinsk)	750k	1,05M	1,32M	1,68M	1,82M	2,15M	2,05M	2,52M
38. Altai Krai Deportee & Grain Hub (Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Slavgorod)	2,28M	2,42M	2,38M	2,56M	2,68M	3,05M	2,86M	3,24M
39. Oyrot/ Gorno-Altai AO, Khakass AO, Minusinsk & Tuva AO (1944 Annex.)	490k	560k	620k	740k	780k	820k	810k	960k
40. East Siberian Trans-Siberian: Krasnoyarsk (Kraslag) & Irkutsk (Ozerlag)	1,92M	2,18M	2,38M	2,88M	3,12M	3,41M	3,32M	3,95M
41. Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag: Norillag (Norilsk), Igarka, Taymyr & Evenkia	110k	150k	190k	260k	310k	370k	390k	500k

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
42. Buryat-Mongol ASSR (1937 Split) & Chita/ Transbaikalia (Bamlag)	1,05M	1,18M	1,31M	1,64M	1,74M	1,72M	1,68M	1,97M
43. Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold, 1942 Churapcha Tragedy & Lena Delta Exiles)	285k	315k	345k	415k	425k	400k	400k	470k
44. Dalstroy Extreme NE Gulag: Kolyma-Magadan (Sevvostlag) & Chukotka	35k	45k	75k	205k	255k	320k	320k	420k
45. S. Far East: Amur, Birobidzhan, Primorye (1937 Koreans) & S. Sakhalin	1,02M	1,27M	1,52M	2,24M	2,56M	2,69M	2,79M	3,64M
Baltic SSRs Total: Estonia, Latvia & Lithuania (Regions 1-3)	5,62M	5,76M	5,87M	6,11M	5,99M	5,38M	4,89M	5,78M
Moldavian SSR Total: Bessarabia & MASSR (Region 4)	2,04M	2,14M	2,19M	2,41M	2,47M	2,12M	2,08M	2,52M
Byelorussian SSR Total (Regions 6-7)	7,18M	7,65M	7,7M	8,4M	8,8M	6,5M	6,3M	7,2M
Ukrainian SSR incl. Crimea Total (Regions 8-15)	36,7M	39M	35,35M	40,02M	41,56M	31,2M	30,15M	35,48M

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Stalin-Era Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1930AD	1933AD	1939AD	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD
Russian SFSR + Karelo-Finnish SSR + Kaliningrad Total (Reg. 5, 16-45)	93,53M	99,3M	98,82M	109,26M	113,75M	101,28M	99,19M	114,37M
Combined Total (All 45 Regions: EE + LV + LT + MD + BY + UA + RU)	145,07M	153,85M	149,93M	166,2M	172,58M	146,48M	142,62M	165,35M

Table 1. Population trajectories across the forty-five Stalin-era regions at primary census, famine and wartime benchmarks (1926AD - 1953AD, in thousands).

Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
1. Estonian SSR (1940 Occup., 1941/49 Priboi & Oil-Shale Inflow)	49.227	1,13M	980k	1,1M	+0,5%	-19%	+3,1%
2. Latvian SSR (1940 Occup., Shoah, Courland & 1949 Priboi)	64.240	1,97M	1,78M	1,95M	+1,6%	-17,3%	+8,1%
3. Lithuanian SSR (1939 Vilnius, Shoah, LLKS & 1948-51 Exiles)	64.449	2,91M	2,51M	2,57M	+2,9%	-18,8%	-0,9%
4. Moldavian SSR (MASSR + 1940 Bessarabia, 1947 Famine & Op. Yug)	31.041	2,31M	1,94M	2,29M	+2,3%	-15,8%	+23,5%
5. Kaliningrad Oblast (1945 Potsdam, German Expulsion & Settlers)	16.065	1,19M	340k	475k	+1,8%	-85,2%	-51,8%
6. Western Belarus (1939 Annex.: Brest, Grodno, Baranavichy)	79.213	2,72M	2,16M	2,24M	+4%	-28,1%	-1,3%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
7. Eastern Byelorussian SSR (Minsk, Vitebsk, Mogilev, Gomel)	122.740	5,28M	4,34M	4,66M	-1%	-28,5%	+1%
8. Western Ukraine: Galicia & Volhynia (1939 Annex., Shoah & UPA)	89.118	7,36M	5,3M	5,5M	+2,9%	-33,1%	-14,1%
9. N. Bukovina & Budjak (1940) + Transcarpathia (1945 Annex.)	41.714	2,62M	1,95M	2,02M	+2%	-30,9%	-11,4%
10. Right-Bank UkSSR (Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Cherkasy Holodomor)	133.097	7,2M	5,98M	6,34M	-18,1%	-24,5%	-19,3%
11. Left-Bank UkSSR (Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy, Chernihiv Holodomor)	111.513	8,35M	6,72M	7,12M	-18,1%	-24,6%	-22,4%
12. Dnieper Industrial Bend (Dnipropetrovsk, Zaporizhzhia, Kryvyi Rih)	83.237	4,05M	3,62M	4,02M	-10,1%	-24,1%	+20%
13. Donbas Coal-Steel Basin (Stalino/Donetsk & Voroshilovgrad/ Luhansk)	52.520	4,55M	4,15M	4,85M	+5,5%	-27,6%	+81,9%
14. Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe (Odesa, Mykolaiv, Kherson)	71.944	2,65M	2,35M	2,63M	-12,5%	-22,4%	+8,3%
15. Crimean ASSR to Oblast (May 1944 Deportation of 191k Tatars)	32.366	920k	680k	820k	+0%	-49,2%	+50,8%
16. Karelo-Finnish SSR (1940-56: Vyborg, 422k Evacuees, BBK) & Murmansk	337.469	1,28M	790k	960k	+14,3%	-39,3%	+30,2%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
17. Leningrad Siege Metropolis, Novgorod & Pskov Oblasts (1941-44)	187.833	5,93M	4,57M	5,07M	+6,6%	-37,6%	+17,1%
18. Komi ASSR (1936: Vorkutlag, Intalag, Ukhtpechlag) & Nenets Okrug	591.270	380k	610k	680k	+21,4%	+14,3%	+212,5%
19. Northern Forestry & Kulak Exile Belt: Arkhangelsk & Vologda	571.371	2,67M	2,54M	2,74M	+5,7%	-15%	+28,5%
20. Moscow Metropolis & Moscow Oblast (Metro, Dmitlag Canal & Hub)	42.148	7,65M	8,55M	9,35M	+16,5%	-8,9%	+119,9%
21. Upper Volga & Western Front (Kalinin, Smolensk, Bryansk, Volgolag)	354.594	12,75M	10,05M	10,48M	-1,8%	-25,8%	-18%
22. Central Black-Earth Belt (Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Tambov, Tula)	262.239	13,25M	10,25M	10,75M	-6,3%	-25,3%	-20,6%
23. Chuvash, Mari, Mordovian (Temlag) & Udmurt ASSRs + Gorky/Kirov	299.637	6,95M	6,75M	6,85M	-1,4%	-8,2%	+2,7%
24. Tatar ASSR & Ulyanovsk-Penza Middle Volga	149.881	5,2M	5,08M	5,15M	-3,7%	-9,1%	+0,2%
25. Kuibyshev (1941-43 Wartime Capital) & Chkalov (Orenburg)	182.041	3,75M	4,22M	4,45M	-5,2%	+0%	+28,2%
26. Volga German ASSR (Liquidated Aug 1941: 438k Germans Deported)	42.455	520k	275k	310k	-20%	-59,7%	-40,6%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
27. Saratov, Stalingrad (1942-43 Battle Ruin) & Astrakhan Lower Volga	220.894	3,89M	3,5M	3,78M	-12,7%	-19,3%	-4,7%
28. Kalmyk ASSR (Liquidated Dec 1943 Op. Ulusy: 93,1k Deported)	72.664	160k	75k	90k	-6,2%	-64,9%	-28,6%
29. Rostov, Krasnodar (1932-33 Kuban Blacklisted Stanitsas) & Adygei AO	195.023	6,52M	6,26M	6,72M	-15,4%	-15,7%	+0,1%
30. Stavropol Krai, Karachay AO (Nov 1943 Deport. 69,3k) & Cherkess AO	88.478	1,56M	1,49M	1,6M	-10,6%	-16,7%	+5,6%
31. Kabardino-Balkar ASSR (Mar 1944 Deport. 37,7k) & N. Ossetian ASSR	19.484	830k	790k	860k	+2,7%	-18,3%	+36,8%
32. Chechen-Ingush ASSR to Grozny Oblast (Feb 1944 Op. Chechevitsa: 493,3k)	15.675	710k	370k	430k	+1,6%	-57%	-16,9%
33. Dagestan ASSR (1944 Aukhovsky Chechen Deport. & Mountain Transfers)	56.471	780k	690k	730k	+0%	-20,9%	+7%
34. Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR (Sverdlovsk, Tankograd, Magnitogorsk)	592.553	10,8M	12,98M	13,75M	+3%	+7,1%	+58,1%
35. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine (Tyumen, Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk)	515.633	4,55M	5,68M	6,02M	+2,8%	+9,3%	+63,4%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
36. Ob-Irtysh Special-Settlement Taiga (Narym/ Nazino, Yugra & Yamal)	1.576.022	640k	760k	790k	+29,2%	+4,2%	+127,8%
37. Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag (Kemerovo 1943: Stalinsk)	92.689	1,55M	2,12M	2,32M	+25,7%	+12,6%	+236%
38. Altai Krai Deportee & Grain Hub (Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Slavgorod)	174.518	2,44M	2,93M	3,09M	-1,7%	+6,7%	+42,1%
39. Oyrot/ Gorno-Altai AO, Khakass AO, Minusinsk & Tuva AO (1944 Annex.)	418.838	680k	840k	900k	+10,7%	+3,8%	+95,9%
40. East Siberian Trans-Siberian: Krasnoyarsk (Kraslag) & Irkutsk (Ozerlag)	867.475	2,62M	3,42M	3,68M	+9,2%	+6,4%	+105,7%
41. Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag: Norillag (Norilsk), Igarka, Taymyr & Evenkia	2.108.950	220k	420k	460k	+26,7%	+25,8%	+354,5%
42. Buryat-Mongol ASSR (1937 Split) & Chita/ Transbaikalia (Bamlag)	840.030	1,48M	1,72M	1,84M	+11%	-3,4%	+87,6%
43. Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold, 1942 Churapcha Tragedy & Lena Delta Exiles)	3.077.152	385k	415k	445k	+9,5%	-5,9%	+64,9%
44. Dalstroy Extreme NE Gulag: Kolyma-Magadan (Sevvostlag) & Chukotka	2.117.525	135k	335k	375k	+66,7%	+25,5%	+1100%

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Stalin-Era Region	Area (km2)	1937AD	1947AD	1950AD	1930-33	1941-45	1926-53
45. S. Far East: Amur, Birobidzhan, Primorye (1937 Koreans) & S. Sakhalin	1.064.421	1,83M	2,96M	3,29M	+19,7%	+9%	+256,9%
Baltic SSRs Total (Regions 1-3)	177.916	6M	5,27M	5,61M	+2%	-18,4%	+2,8%
Moldavian SSR Total (Region 4)	31.041	2,31M	1,94M	2,29M	+2,3%	-15,8%	+23,5%
Byelorussian SSR Total (Regions 6-7)	201.953	8M	6,5M	6,9M	+0,7%	-28,4%	+0,3%
Ukrainian SSR incl. Crimea Total (Regions 8-15)	615.509	37,7M	30,75M	33,3M	-9,4%	-27,5%	-3,3%
Russian SFSR + Karelo-Finnish SSR + Kaliningrad Total (Reg. 5, 16-45)	17.151.498	103,3M	101,78M	108,43M	-0,5%	-12,8%	+22,3%
Combined Total (All 45 Regions)	18.177.917	157,31M	146,24M	156,53M	-2,5%	-17,4%	+14%

Table 2. Regional areas, intermediate demographic benchmarks (1937AD, 1947AD and 1950AD) and net percentage shifts across the forty-five Stalin-era regions.

Collectivisation, Dekulakisation and the 1932-1933AD Famines

Kulak Special Settlers and the Nazino Island Tragedy

The demographic rupture of the 1930s commenced in November 1929AD with comprehensive forced collectivisation (*sploshnaya kollektivizatsiya*) and the Politburo resolution of 30 January 1930AD (“On Measures for the Elimination of Kulak Households in Districts of Comprehensive Collectivisation”) [3][6]. Peasant households were divided into three categories: first-category “counter-revolutionaries” (~63k household heads arrested by the OGPU in 1930AD, many executed or sent to concentration camps), second-category households slated for freight-train deportation to remote northern, Ural and Siberian special settlements (*spetsposelki*), and third-category households dispossessed and resettled on marginal plots within their home districts (archived PDF; archived PDF) [5][38][39].

Declassified OGPU-NKVD ledgers compiled by Viktor Zemskov (1990, 2003) establish that during the two main waves of 1930-1931AD, 381.026 peasant families comprising 1.803.392 persons were exiled into “kulak special settlements” (*kulatskaya ssylka*); including 1932-1933AD supplemental deportations (such as blacklisted Kuban Cossack stanitsas and Western Siberian/Ukrainian arrears sweeps), total dekulakised exiles reached ~2,1M [4][5][6]. By region of origin, the 1.803.392 *spetspereselentsy* of 1930-1931AD were uprooted primarily from the Ukrainian SSR (Regions 10-14, 63.720 families, ~301.500 persons), the North Caucasus and Kuban-Don (Regions 29-32, 38.404 families, ~191.900 persons), the Lower and Middle Volga (Regions 24-27, 47.264 families, ~230.500 persons, including ~26k Volga Germans from Region 26), the Central Black-Earth Belt (Region 22, 26.006 families, ~130.000 persons), the Urals and Bashkiria (Region

34, 35.450 families, ~172.000 persons), Western and Eastern Siberia (Regions 35-40, 68.500 families, ~335.000 persons) and Eastern Belarus (Region 7, 15.724 families, ~76.800 persons) [6][38].

Across our 45-region partition, these exiles were consigned to seven primary reception zones (Table 3). The Great Ural Arsenal and Bashkir ASSR (Region 34) received the largest single contingent (117.195 families, 561.429 persons in 1930-1931AD), deployed to timber camps (*lespromkhozy*), bauxite and potash mines (Nadezhdinsk/Serov, Solikamsk, Berezniki and Kizel) and the blast-furnace foundations of Magnitogorsk (40k+ special settlers) and Nizhny Tagil [39][40]. In the European North, the Northern Forestry Belt of Arkhangelsk and Vologda (Region 19) together with the Komi ASSR and *Ukhtpechlag* (Region 18) received 57.716 families (290.025 persons) in 1930-1931AD; distributed across logging clearings along the Northern Dvina, Vychegda and Pechora rivers (Kotlas, Pinega, Syktyvkar, Ust-Kulom and Ukhta), winter exposure and scurvy killed over 45k of these deportees between 1930AD and 1932AD [6].

Further east, the Ob-Irtysh special-settlement taiga and tundra of Narym Okrug and the Ostyak-Vogul and Yamal-Nenets Okrugs (Region 36) absorbed ~265.000 kulak exiles and "declassed elements" shipped by barge down the Ob, Irtysh, Tom, Vasyugan and Parabel rivers into the swamps of Narym Okrug (~196.000 settlers across Parabel, Kargasok, Kolpashevo and Vasyugan) and the newly created (December 1930AD) Ostyak-Vogul (Khanty-Mansi) and Yamal-Nenets National Okrugs (Samarovo/Khanty-Mansiysk, Surgut, Berezovo and Salekhard) [6][7]. This forced influx drove Region 36 up by +33,3% from 360k in 1926AD to 480k in 1930AD and +29,2% to 620k in 1933AD (Figure 3). In May 1933AD, the Nazino Island Tragedy unfolded at the confluence of the Ob and Nazina rivers in Alexandrovsky Raion (Region 36), when some 6.700 "socially harmful elements" and famine refugees rounded up in Moscow and Leningrad under passport-cleansing quotas were marooned without food, tools or shelter on swampy Nazino Island; within thirteen weeks, more than 4.000 perished from starvation, exposure, typhus and cannibalism [7].

In southern Siberia and the Far East, the Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine and *Siblag* (Region 37) together with the Khakass AO and Minusinsk (Region 39) received ~145.000 special settlers assigned to coal mines at Prokopyevsk, Anzhero-Sudzhensk, Leninsk-Kuznetsky and Kemerovo, the Kuznetsk Metallurgical Combine at Stalinsk, and gold and coal mines in Khakassia (Chernogorsk, Balyksinsk and Sarala) [6]. Meanwhile, East Siberia, Yenisei-Taymyr, the Aldan goldfields and the Southern Far East (Regions 40, 41, 43 and 45) took in ~185.000 special settlers, notably at the Arctic timber-export port of Igarka (Region 41, where >20k kulak exiles built sawmills on permafrost at 67,5°N), the Aldan goldfields (Region 43) and Far Eastern mining and timber districts (Region 45). Between 1930AD and 1934AD, recorded deaths in the kulak special settlements exceeded 500.000, including 151.601 deaths (13,7% of the entire contingent) in the famine year 1933AD alone [6].

Special-Settlement Reception Region (45-Region Partition)	1930-31 Families	1930-33 Deportees	Primary Origins & Demographic/ Settlement Impact
Reg. 34: Great Ural Arsenal & Bashkir ASSR (Magnitogorsk, Serov, Solikamsk, Tagil)	117.195	561.429	From Ukraine, Kuban, Volga & Black-Earth; built Magnitogorsk (40k exiles), Kizel coal & Ural timber
Reg. 19 & Reg. 18: Northern Krai (Arkhangelsk, Kotlas) & Komi ASSR (Syktyvkar, Ukhta)	57.716	290.025	From Ukraine, Belarus & Central Russia; cleared Dvina/Pechora timber; Reg. 18 grew +41,7% (1926-33)
Reg. 36: Ob-Irtysh Taiga: Narym Okrug (Vasyugan, Nazino) & Ostyak-Vogul/Yamal	52.400	265.000	From Ukraine, Volga & W. Siberia; Narym swamps & May 1933 Nazino Island tragedy (>4.000 of 6.700 died)

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Special-Settlement Reception Region (45-Region Partition)	1930-31 Families	1930-33 Deportees	Primary Origins & Demographic/ Settlement Impact
Reg. 37 & Reg. 39: Kuzbass Coal-Steel (Stalinsk, Prokopyevsk) & Khakassia Mines	31.200	145.000	From Volga, Black-Earth & Siberia; staffed Kuzbass coal shafts, Siblag & Khakass gold/coal mines
Reg. 35 & Reg. 38: Southern West Siberia (Omsk, Novosibirsk) & Altai Krai	22.100	105.000	Internal West Siberian & Ukrainian kulaks settled in Baraba steppe and northern Altai timber tracts
Reg. 40 & Reg. 41: Krasnoyarsk Krai, Irkutsk & Igarka Arctic Timber Port	26.800	130.000	Built Igarka permafrost port (Reg. 41: +72,7% in 1926-33) & Yenisei/ Angara logging settlements
Reg. 42, 43 & 45: Transbaikalia, Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold) & Southern Far East	21.400	102.000	Staffed Aldan goldfields (Reg. 43), Transbaikal mines & Far Eastern timber/coal camps (Reg. 45)
Kazakhstan, Central Asia, North Caucasus Steppe & Internal Regional Exile	52.215	501.546	Included Karaganda coal basin (Kazakhstan) & internal third-category resettlement zones
All-Union Kulak Special-Settlement Total (1930-1933AD OGPU-NKVD Accounting)	381.026	2.100.000	1.803.392 deported in 1930-31 (+300k in 1932-33); >500k died in exile (151.601 deaths in 1933AD)

Table 3. Origin-to-destination accounting of dekulakised peasant special settlers across the forty-five Stalin-era regions from 1930AD to 1933AD.

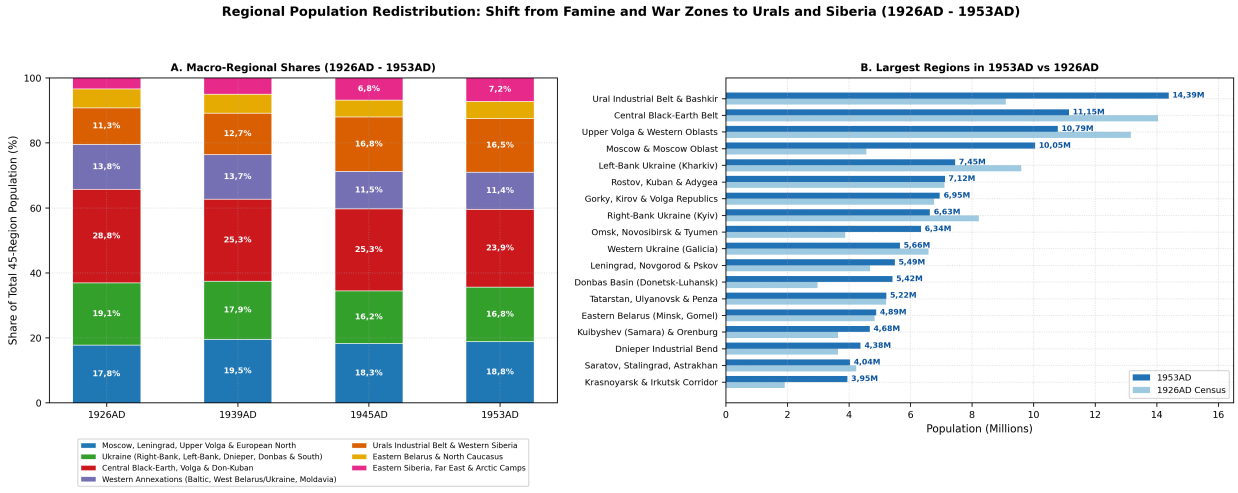


Figure 3. Regional percentage population shifts during the 1930AD - 1933AD collectivisation famines and the 1941AD - 1953AD wartime and post-war era.

The 1932-1933AD Famines in Ukraine, Moldavia and Russia

In the Ukrainian SSR, the combination of collectivisation livestock losses, extortionate 1932AD state grain-procurement quotas (*khlebozagotovki*), "natural meat and potato fines" (*naturalnye shtrafy*), the "blackboard" blockade regime (*chernye doski*) and Stalin and Molotov's secret directive of 22 January 1933AD forbidding peasant exit from Ukraine and the Kuban produced the Holodomor [8][9][41]. Reconstructions by the Ptoukha Institute and the Harvard Ukrainian Research Institute (HURI) MAPA project establish 3,94M direct excess deaths across the interwar Ukrainian SSR (including the Moldavian ASSR) during 1932-1934AD (3,53M in 1933AD alone) plus 0,59M lost births, for a total demographic loss of 4,53M [8][9].

Our 45-region partition separates the interwar Polish, Romanian, Baltic and Czechoslovak borderlands (Regions 1-3, the Bessarabian majority of Region 4, and Regions 6, 8 and 9, which lay outside Soviet borders in 1932-1933AD) from the five Soviet Ukrainian regions (Regions 10 to 14) and the Russian famine regions (Regions 22 and 24-30) (Figure 3 and Table 4). With the Moldavian SSR assigned to Region 4, Right-Bank Ukraine (Region 10: Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr and Cherkasy) suffered rural excess mortality rates of 165 to 250+ per 1.000 in Tetiev, Bila Tserkva, Uman and Vinnytsia raions, falling by -18,1% from 8,56M in 1930AD to 7,01M in 1933AD (-1,55M net loss; ~1,65M direct famine deaths) [9]. Meanwhile, in the left-bank Moldavian ASSR (Balta and Tiraspol districts, split in 1940AD between Region 4 and Region 14), ~50k to 67k inhabitants died during the 1932-1933AD famine (archived PDF) [20][42]. Left-Bank Ukraine (Region 11: Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy and Chernihiv) was subjected to sweeping household food confiscations and *chernye doski* blockades (such as Liutenka and Kamiani Potoky), falling by -18,1% from 9,95M in 1930AD to 8,15M in 1933AD (-1,8M net loss; ~1,29M direct famine deaths) [8]. Further south, the Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe of Odesa, Mykolaiv and Kherson including Balta (Region 14) fell by -12,5% (2,79M to 2,44M; ~395k direct deaths including northern MASSR raions retained in Odesa Oblast), and the Dnieper Industrial Bend (Region 12) fell by -10,1% (3,95M to 3,55M; ~370k rural famine deaths partially offset by industrial construction at Zaporizhzhia's DniproHES and Kryvyi Rih), whereas the Donbas (Region 13) rose by +5,5% (3,65M to 3,85M) as priority coal and steel rations drew starving peasants into Stalino and Voroshilovgrad mines despite ~230k rural Donetsk famine deaths.

Across the Russian SFSR, the Volga German ASSR (Region 26) suffered the steepest percentage drop of any Russian unit in 1930-1933AD, falling by -20% from 600k in 1930AD to 480k in 1933AD as relentless grain requisitions across Marxstadt, Balzer, Seelmann and Frank cantons killed ~65k to 80k Volga Germans and triggered flight across the Volga [10][43]; adjacent Saratov, Stalingrad and Astrakhan on the Lower Volga (Region 27) fell by -12,7% (4,4M to 3,84M; ~405k direct famine deaths). In the North Caucasus, directed by Lazar Kaganovich's November 1932AD commission, the OGPU placed fifteen major Kuban Cossack stanitsas (n=15) on "blackboards" (*chernye doski*), cordoned them off from trade and food, and deported the entire surviving population of Ukrainian-speaking Poltavskaya (~27k residents, renamed Krasnoarmeyskaya), Medvedovskaya and Urupskaya to the northern Gulag while resettling demobilised Red Army soldiers into their homes (archived PDF) [10][11]. Rostov, Krasnodar/Kuban and the Adygei AO (Region 29) fell by -15,4% from 7,42M in 1930AD to 6,28M in 1933AD, while Stavropol and Karachay-Cherkessia (Region 30) fell by -10,6% (1,7M to 1,52M; ~620k combined North Caucasus famine deaths). To the north, the Central Black-Earth Belt (Region 22) dropped by -6,3% (14,35M to 13,45M; ~520k direct famine deaths in Voronezh, Kursk, Belgorod and Tambov), Kuibyshev and Chkalov (Region 25) fell by -5,2% (3,85M to 3,65M), and the Tatar ASSR and Ulyanovsk-Penza (Region 24) fell by -3,7% (5,35M to 5,15M) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [44][45][46].

Stalin-Era Famine Region (45-Region Partition)	1930AD	1933AD	1930-33 Shift	Direct Deaths	Raion Mortality & Repression Mechanisms
Reg. 10: Right-Bank Ukrainian SSR (Kyiv, Vinnytsia, Zhytomyr, Cherkasy)	8,56M	7,01M	-18,1%	1,65M	165-250+ per 1k (Tetiev, Uman, Bila Tserkva); natural meat/potato fines & border cordons
Reg. 11: Left-Bank Ukrainian SSR (Kharkiv, Poltava, Sumy, Chernihiv)	9,95M	8,15M	-18,1%	1,29M	155-210 per 1k; chernye doski (blackboards), OGPU rail blocks & June 1933 mortality peak
Reg. 12: Dnieper Industrial Bend (Dnipropetrovsk, Zaporizhzhia, Kirovohrad)	3,95M	3,55M	-10,1%	370k	138 per 1k; rural famine sweeps partially offset in aggregate by DniproHES/ Kryvyi Rih boom
Reg. 13: Donbas Basin (Stalino/Donetsk & Voroshilovgrad/Luhansk)	3,65M	3,85M	+5,5%	230k	68 per 1k; rural Donetsk starvation offset by priority coal/steel rations & in-migration
Reg. 14: Ukrainian Black Sea Steppe (Odesa, Mykolaiv, Kherson, Balta)	2,79M	2,44M	-12,5%	397k	152 per 1k; steppe & Balta/ MASSR requisitions (+50k deaths in Tiraspol/ left-bank MASSR)
Ukrainian SSR Famine Zone Total (Regions 10-14, excl. W. Ukraine Reg. 8-9)	28,9M	25M	-13,5%	3,94M	133 per 1k; 3,94M direct deaths + 0,59M lost births (4,53M total Holodomor deficit)
Reg. 26: Volga German ASSR (Engels, Marxstadt, Balzer, Seelmann Cantons)	600k	480k	-20%	75k	135 per 1k; extreme requisitions across Volga German cantons; -20% net population drop
Reg. 27: Lower Volga (Saratov, Stalingrad & Astrakhan)	4,4M	3,84M	-12,7%	405k	108 per 1k; total seed/grain sweeps across Saratov & Stalingrad rural khutors
Reg. 29: Rostov, Krasnodar (Kuban Blacklisted Stanitsas) & Adygei AO	7,42M	6,28M	-15,4%	480k	132 per 1k; Kaganovich commission, 15 Cossack stanitsas blacklisted (Poltavskaya exiled)
Reg. 30: Stavropol Krai, Karachay AO & Cherkess AO	1,7M	1,52M	-10,6%	140k	105 per 1k; grain confiscations & kulak deportations across Stavropol & Terek steppe
Reg. 22: Central Black-Earth Belt (Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Tambov)	14,35M	13,45M	-6,3%	520k	64 per 1k; spring-summer 1933 famine across Voronezh, Kursk, Belgorod & Tambov

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Stalin-Era Famine Region (45-Region Partition)	1930AD	1933AD	1930-33 Shift	Direct Deaths	Raion Mortality & Repression Mechanisms
Reg. 24 & Reg. 25: Middle Volga (Tatar ASSR, Penza, Kuibyshev, Chkalov)	9,2M	8,8M	-4,3%	370k	55 per 1k; grain requisitions across Samara, Orenburg, Penza & Ulyanovsk
Russian SFSR + KFSSR Total (Regions 16-45, 2,63M Direct Famine Deaths)	98,16M	97,66M	-0,5%	2,63M	2,63M direct famine deaths + 0,67M lost births across RSFSR (+640k in Urals/Siberia/Rest)

Table 4. Population shifts, direct famine mortality and repression mechanisms across Ukrainian and Russian famine regions from 1930AD to 1933AD.

The Western Annexations (Regions 1 to 5)

The forty-five-region partition incorporates five western borderland territories whose demographic trajectories between 1926AD and 1953AD were transformed by the August 1939AD Molotov-Ribbentrop secret protocols, the 1939-1941AD German *Umsiedlung*, the 1940AD Soviet annexations and June 1941AD NKVD deportations, the 1941-1944AD German and Romanian occupations and the Holocaust, wartime sea flight and post-war population expulsions, prolonged anti-Soviet partisan insurgencies, the severe 1946-1947AD Moldavian famine and the 1948-1951AD mass collectivisation deportations (Operations *Vesna*, *Priboi*, *Yug* and *Osen*) (Table 5) [4][18][20][28][47].

Estonian SSR (Region 1)

In interwar independent Estonia (49.227 km2), low Western European-style fertility and modest urban growth in Tallinn (127k in 1926AD to 145k in 1939AD), Tartu (59k to 60,1k) and Narva carried the population slowly from 1,11M in 1926AD to 1,13M in September 1939AD [48][49]. Between October 1939AD and June 1941AD, Estonia lost ~80k inhabitants (1,13M to 1,05M): following Hitler's 6 October 1939AD Reichstag call, ~14.000 Baltic Germans departed during the 1939-1940AD *Umsiedlung* (followed by ~7.000 *Nachumsiedler* in early 1941AD); after the June-August 1940AD Soviet occupation and annexation, NKVD troops arrested ~8.000 political and military figures, deported 10.157 men, women and children on 14 June 1941AD to Kirov Oblast and Novosibirsk/Tomsk (Regions 35-36), and conscripted ~33.000 Estonian men into Red Army labour battalions in the summer of 1941AD (archived PDF; archived PDF) [17][50][51].

Under German occupation (July 1941AD - September 1944AD), *Einsatzgruppe A* and Estonian collaborationist units murdered virtually all ~1.000 Estonian Jews remaining in the country (such that German authorities declared Estonia *judenfrei* at the January 1942AD Wannsee Conference) alongside ~7.000 to 8.000 foreign Jews transported to the Vaivara, Klooga and Kalevi-Liiva camps and ~7.800 local civilians and Roma (archived PDF) [17][52]. As the Red Army breached the Narva front (destroying >95% of baroque Narva, whose population fell from 23,8k in 1939AD to 6,6k in 1945AD) and reoccupied Tallinn in autumn 1944AD, 75.000 to 80.000 Estonians (together with ~7.000 Estonian Swedes from Vormsi, Noarootsi and Ruhnu) fled across the Baltic Sea to Sweden and Germany [48][49]. In January 1945AD, Moscow detached eastern Ivangorod and the bulk of Petseri (*Pechory*) County (~2.300 km2, ~55k-65k inhabitants) from the Estonian SSR into Leningrad and Pskov Oblasts (Region 17), depressing Estonia's

post-war trough to 854k in late 1945AD (-24,7% below 1939AD).

Post-war Sovietisation provoked armed resistance by ~14.000 to 15.000 Estonian *Metsavennad* (Forest Brothers) across Virumaa, Vorumaa and Parnumaa [17][28]. To crush rural support for the insurgents and force peasant entry into kolkhozes, MGB and MVD troops executed Operation *Priboi* ("Coastal Surf") on 25-28 March 1949AD, deporting 20.702 Estonians (7.552 families, >70% women and children under sixteen) in 19 freight echelons to Novosibirsk, Omsk, Krasnoyarsk and Irkutsk Oblasts (Regions 35 and 40) (archived PDF) [18][50]. Simultaneously, rapid all-Union investment in the northeastern Virumaa oil-shale gas basin (Kohtla-Jarve, founded as a city in 1946AD to supply piped shale gas to Leningrad, growing to 29k by 1953AD), Kreenholm textiles in Narva (21k in 1953AD, after indigenous pre-war residents were barred from returning) and the secret Combine No. 7 uranium-enrichment facility at Sillamae (10k in 1953AD) brought >180.000 Russian, Belarusian and Ingrian industrial migrants into Estonia, lifting Region 1 to 1,15M by 1953AD while reducing the ethnic Estonian share from 88,2% (1934AD) to ~75% (archived PDF) [48][49][53].

Latvian SSR (Region 2)

Interwar Latvia (64.240 km2) expanded from 1,86M in 1926AD to 2M in 1939AD, anchored by Riga (339k to 385k), Liepaja (57k), Daugavpils (43k to 51,7k) and Jelgava (28,3k to 34,1k) [54][55]. Between October 1939AD and June 1941AD, the *Umsiedlung* removed ~51.000 Baltic Germans (plus ~10.500 in early 1941AD), virtually ending seven centuries of German urban presence in Riga and Courland; following the June-August 1940AD Soviet annexation, the NKVD deported 15.424 Latvian citizens (disproportionately targeting political, military and Jewish business elites) on 14 June 1941AD to Krasnoyarsk Krai (Region 40), Tomsk/Novosibirsk (Regions 35-36) and the Vyatlag/Usollag camps (Regions 23 and 34), where ~34% perished (archived PDF) [56][57].

During the 1941-1945AD German occupation (*Reichskommissariat Ostland*), the Latvian Holocaust annihilated ~70.000 Latvian Jews (~90% of the pre-war Jewish community not evacuated to the Soviet interior) alongside ~20.000 Reich Jews deported from Germany, Austria and Czechoslovakia and ~2.000 Latvian Roma [23][56]. On 30 November and 8 December 1941AD, SS Gen. Friedrich Jeckeln's forces and the Arajs Kommando shot 25.000 Jews from the Riga Ghetto in the Rumbula forest, alongside mass shootings in Bikernieki forest (~35k-46k total victims), the Skede dunes outside Liepaja, Daugavpils Citadel and Rezekne [23]. Heavy conscription into the Latvian Waffen-SS Legion (~110k-115k) and the Red Army, fierce 1944-1945AD fighting around Jelgava and the Courland Pocket (*Kurzemes cietoksnis*, which held out until 8 May 1945AD), the flight of 120.000 to 150.000 Latvian refugees by sea to Germany and Sweden, and the August 1944AD transfer of eastern Abrene (*Pytalovo*) district (1.293 km2, ~45k inhabitants) to RSFSR Pskov Oblast (Region 17) reduced Latvia's population by -20,8% from 2M (1939AD) to 1,58M in 1945AD [55][56].

Between 1944AD and 1953AD, ~20.000 Latvian national partisans (*Nacionalie partizani*) waged guerrilla warfare in the forests of Kurzeme, Vidzeme and Latgale [28]. During Operation *Priboi* (25-29 March 1949AD), 33 echelons deported 42.149 Latvians (13.624 families - 2,3% of Latvia's population in four days) to Amur Oblast (Region 45), Omsk and Tomsk Oblasts (Regions 35-36), triggering rapid collectivisation (11% to >90% of farms by late 1949AD) [18][57]. Simultaneously, heavy union-ministry industrialisation in Riga (*VEF* electronics, *RVR* railcars, shipbuilding; growing from 228k in late 1944/1945AD to 530k in 1953AD), Daugavpils (56k) and Liepaja (64k) drew >350.000 Russian, Belarusian and Ukrainian workers and military personnel, carrying Region 2 to 2,01M by 1953AD while lowering the ethnic Latvian share from 77% (1935AD) to ~62% [54][56].

Lithuanian SSR (Region 3)

Lithuania (64.449 km2, evaluated across its post-1945AD borders including both the Vilnius region and Klaipeda/Memel) grew from 2,65M in 1926AD to 2,98M in 1939AD and 3,03M in early 1941AD [58][59]. Its borders shifted twice before Barbarossa: in March 1939AD Germany annexed the Klaipeda (*Memel*) Territory (~154k inhabitants), whereas in October 1939AD - after invading eastern Poland - the USSR transferred the city of Vilnius (*Wilno*, 209k in 1939AD) and its immediate hinterland (~549k inhabitants) to Lithuania, followed by full Soviet occupation in June 1940AD (adding Swieciany/Svencionys and Druskininkai from Belarus), the early-1941AD *Umsiedlung* of ~50.000 ethnic Germans and German-registered Lutherans, and the 14-18 June 1941AD NKVD deportation of 17.485 people to Altai Krai (Region 38), Novosibirsk (Region 35) and the Komi ASSR (Region 18, *Sevzheldorlag* and *Vorkutlag*) [19][58][60].

Between June and December 1941AD, *Einsatzkommando 3* (Karl Jager) and Lithuanian collaborationist auxiliaries (*Ypatingasis burys* and TDA battalions) murdered 190.000 to 195.000 Lithuanian and Vilnius Jews - over 91-95% of Lithuania's pre-war Jewish population - at Ponary (*Paneriai*) outside Vilnius (~70.000 Jews shot alongside ~20.000 Polish intelligentsia and Soviet POWs), the Ninth Fort at Kaunas (>30.000 victims) and over two hundred provincial *shtetl* murder pits across Siauliai, Panevezys, Ukmerge and Alytus [23][58]. In late 1944AD and January 1945AD, ~60.000 Lithuanians fled west, while retreating Wehrmacht authorities evacuated virtually the entire civilian population of Klaipeda (reducing the port from 48,5k in 1939AD to fewer than 4k-6k civilians at liberation in January 1945AD). Between 1945AD and 1946AD, under the Polish-Lithuanian evacuation agreements, 170.000 to 197.156 ethnic Poles were repatriated from Vilnius (110k in 1945AD) and eastern Lithuania to Poland, transforming Vilnius from a Polish-Jewish city into a Soviet Lithuanian-Russian administrative capital [58].

Unlike Estonia and Latvia, post-war Lithuania experienced minimal all-Union Slavic industrial immigration before 1953AD because the countryside was engulfed in a prolonged anti-Soviet guerrilla war (1944-1953AD): the Lithuanian Forest Brothers (*Misko broliai*, united in 1949AD as the Movement of the Struggle for Freedom of Lithuania, *LLKS*, under Jonas Zemaitis and Adolfas Ramanauskas) mobilised ~30.000 to 50.000 active fighters over the conflict, losing 20.101 partisans killed in combat while killing ~13.000 MGB/MVD personnel, *istrebiteli* militia and Soviet activists (archived PDF) [19][28][61]. In retaliation, Moscow subjected Lithuania to four serial deportations totalling 131.600 to 132.000 post-war deportees between 1945AD and 1953AD (plus ~142.000 Gulag political prisoners). Early post-war sweeps in 1945-1947AD exiled ~12.000 partisans' relatives and Lithuanian Germans to Tajikistan, Komi (Region 18) and Sverdlovsk (Region 34). In Operation *Vesna* ("Spring", 22-23 May 1948AD), the largest single deportation in Lithuanian history, 30.000 MGB/MVD troops deported 40.002 to 48.000 Lithuanians (11.345+ families) to timber camps in Irkutsk Oblast (Region 40: Igirma, Bodaibo, Tayshet and Tulun), Krasnoyarsk Krai (Regions 40-41: Igarka and Yeniseysk) and the Buryat-Mongol ASSR (Region 42) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [60][62][63]. Operation *Priboi* (25-28 March 1949AD) deported a further 29.180 to 32.000 Lithuanians (8.765 families) to Irkutsk and Krasnoyarsk [18][60], and Operation *Osen* ("Autumn", 2-3 October 1951AD) deported 16.150 to 20.357 remaining *kulak* family members to Krasnoyarsk and Tomsk Oblasts alongside smaller sweeps into the Kazakh SSR (archived PDF) [60][64]. Consequently, Lithuania (Region 3) fell from 3,03M in 1941AD to 2,46M in 1945AD (-18,8%) and recovered only to 2,62M by 1953AD (-13,5% below 1941AD and -0,9% below its 1926AD baseline).

Moldavian SSR (Region 4)

Region 4 (31.041 km2) unites central and northern Bessarabia (Chisinau, Balti, Bender, Orhei, Soroca and Cahul - held by Greater Romania from 1918AD to June 1940AD) with the western Transnistrian bank of the Moldavian ASSR (MASSR, 1924-1940AD: Tiraspol, Ribnita, Dubasari and Slobozia), while assigning northern and eastern MASSR raions (Balta, Birzula/Kotovsk and Ananiv) to Ukrainian Region 14 and

southern Budjak (Izmail and Cetatea Alba/Bilhorod-Dnistrovskyi) to Ukrainian Region 9 (archived PDF) [20][42]. During the interwar period, left-bank MASSR (572,3k in 1926AD across all 11 original raions) endured dekulakisation, the 1932-1933AD famine (~50k-67k excess deaths, prompting peasant attempts to swim the Dniester into Romania under OGPU border-guard fire, such as the February 1932AD Olaneasca/Oloneshty crossing) and the 1937-1938AD NKVD "Romanian Operation" (~5.500+ executions in Tiraspol), whereas Romanian-ruled Bessarabia experienced high rural natural increase, lifting Region 4 overall from 2,04M (1926AD) to 2,41M (1939AD) [20][42].

On 28 June 1940AD, following the Soviet ultimatum to Romania, the Red Army occupied Bessarabia and on 2 August 1940AD proclaimed the Moldavian SSR with its capital at Chisinau [20]. In autumn 1940AD, 93.468 Bessarabian Germans evacuated from southern and central German colonies under the Nazi-Soviet *Umsiedlung* (*Heim ins Reich*), tens of thousands of Romanian officials fled across the Prut, and on 12-13 June 1941AD the NKVD arrested or deported 22.648 to 29.839 inhabitants from the Moldavian SSR (and ~6k-11k from Chernivtsi/Izmail in Region 9) to Kazakhstan, Omsk, Novosibirsk and Komi [4][20].

During the 1941-1944AD Axis campaign, Ion Antonescu's Romanian regime reoccupied Bessarabia and administered *Transnistria* between the Dniester and Southern Bug (Regions 4, 9, 10 and 14), perpetrating the Bessarabian and Transnistrian Holocaust (archived PDF; archived PDF; archived PDF) [23][24][65][66]. Romanian gendarmes, army units and German *Einsatzgruppe D* murdered ~45k-60k Jews directly in Bessarabian ghettos and transit camps (Chisinau Ghetto, Marculesti, Vertujeni and Edinet) and force-marched the survivors alongside Bukovinian Jews and 25.000 Romanian Roma into starvation and typhus camps across Transnistria (Bogdanovka, Domanevka, Akhmetchetka, Vapniarka and Mogilev-Podolsky), where 200.000 to 280.000 local and deported Jews and ~11.000 Roma perished [24][66]. Heavy 1944AD combat during the Jassy-Kishinev Offensive, which left central Chisinau >70% destroyed and reduced the city from 112k in 1939AD to 65k in 1945AD, depressed Region 4 from 2,47M (1941AD) to 2,08M in 1945AD.

Between autumn 1946AD and summer 1947AD, severe two-year drought across Bessarabia combined with MGB and party grain-procurement sweeps (*khlebozagotovki* enforced despite near-total crop failure) triggered the 1946-1947AD Moldavian Famine (archived PDF) [20][26][27][67]. Excess deaths in the Moldavian SSR reached 115.000 to 200.000 (5% to 8% of the republic's population - the highest per-capita mortality anywhere in the post-war USSR), accompanied by >390.000 cases of alimentary dystrophy and hundreds of documented cases of cannibalism in Cahul, Bender, Orhei and Balti districts, driving Region 4 down further from 2,08M (1945AD) to its 1,94M famine trough in 1947AD [26][27]. Two years later, on 6-7 July 1949AD, MGB forces executed Operation *Yug* ("South"), deporting 35.796 Moldavian peasants (11.293 families labelled *kulaks*, former Romanian landowners or Jehovah's Witnesses - followed by 2.617 Jehovah's Witnesses in April 1951AD Operation *Sever*) in 30 freight echelons to Kurgan and Tyumen Oblasts (Region 35), Altai Krai (Region 38), Irkutsk (Region 40) and the Kazakh SSR, breaking peasant resistance to full collectivisation under First Secretary Nikolay Koval and his 1950-1952AD successor Leonid Brezhnev (archived PDF) [20][68]. High rural post-famine natality and Slavic administrative and industrial in-migration to Chisinau (165k in 1953AD) and Tiraspol (48k) then restored Region 4 to 2,52M by 1953AD.

Kaliningrad Oblast (Region 5)

Region 5 (16.065 km2) isolates Northern East Prussia, awarded to the USSR at the July-August 1945AD Potsdam Conference and incorporated directly into the Russian SFSR on 7 April 1946AD as *Konigsberg Oblast* (renamed Kaliningrad Oblast on 4 July 1946AD) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [25][47][69][70]. Under Weimar and Nazi rule, Northern East Prussia was a densely settled German urban and agrarian province (1,12M in 1926AD to 1,21M in the May 1939AD Reich census to 1,22M in 1941AD), led by the provincial capital and Baltic port of Konigsberg (287k in 1926AD to 372,2k in 1939AD), Tilsit (*Sovetsk*, 50,8k to 59,1k), Insterburg (*Chernyakhovsk*, 39,3k to 48,7k), Pillau (*Baltiysk*, 12,4k) and Gumbinnen (*Gusev*, 24,6k).

During the Red Army's East Prussian Offensive (January - April 1945AD), the storming of Konigsberg (6-9 April 1945AD) and the Samland/Pillau battles, ~900.000 to 1.000.000 German civilians fled west across the Frische Haff and by sea from Pillau or perished in combat, leaving an estimated 129.000 to 139.000 surviving German civilians (mostly women, children and the elderly, alongside initial Red Army garrisons and repatriated POWs, yielding 180k total inhabitants in late 1945AD - an -85,2% demographic drop from 1941AD, the steepest wartime decline of all 45 regions) (archived PDF) [47][71]. Between 1945AD and 1947AD, severe hunger, typhus, forced labour and lack of rations reduced the surviving German civilian population to ~103.000 (with documented exhaustion mortality and isolated starvation crimes during the 1946-1947AD winter) [47][69]. Under Council of Ministers Resolution No. 3547-1169ss (11 October 1947AD), MVD authorities carried out the compulsory deportation of 102.125 to 102.405 remaining Germans between October 1947AD and November 1948AD (plus final stragglers in 1951AD) in 48 passenger and freight trains to the Soviet Occupation Zone of Germany, effecting a 100% ethnic and toponymic replacement of the province [25][71].

To repopulate the shattered cities and flooded polder farmland, Stalin signed Resolution No. 1298 (21 June 1946AD), launching a large organised resettlement campaign (*Pereselencheskoe upravlenie*) from thirty war-ravaged oblasts and republics (n=30) - above all Bryansk, Smolensk, Kalinin, Oryol, Kursk, Voronezh, Tambov and Gorky Oblasts (Regions 21-23), the Mordovian and Chuvash ASSRs (Region 23) and Belarus (Regions 6-7) - alongside demobilised Baltic Fleet sailors at Baltiysk and Kaliningrad (archived PDF) [25][70][72]. Despite high reverse migration (25-35% of early kolkhoz settlers left due to ruined housing and unfamiliar drainage systems), steady state recruitment lifted Region 5 from 180k (1945AD) to 340k (1947AD), 475k (1950AD) and 540k in 1953AD (Kaliningrad city reaching 175k, Sovetsk 28k and Chernyakhovsk 26k), still -55,7% below its 1941AD pre-war level.

Western Soviet Region (1926-1953AD)	**1926AD**	**1941AD**	**1945AD**	**1947AD**	**1953AD**	**Umsiedlung, Shoah, Flight, Famine & 1948-51 Deportations**
Reg. 1: Estonian SSR (Tallinn, Tartu, Kohtla-Jarve, Narva, Sillamae)	1,11M	1,05M	854k	980k	1,15M	21k Germans out; 10,2k exiled (1941); 78k fled sea (1944); Ivangorod/Petseri to RSFSR; 20,7k Priboi (Mar 1949); >180k shale/ uranium workers in
Reg. 2: Latvian SSR (Riga, Liepaja, Daugavpils, Jelgava, Ventspils)	1,86M	1,91M	1,58M	1,78M	2,01M	61k Germans out; 15,4k exiled (1941); 70k Latvian Jews murdered (Rumbula); 135k fled West; Abrene to RSFSR; 42,1k Priboi (1949); >350k Slavic workers in
Reg. 3: Lithuanian SSR (Vilnius, Kaunas, Klaipeda, Siauliai, Panevezys)	2,65M	3,03M	2,46M	2,51M	2,62M	50k Germans out; 17,5k exiled (1941); 195k Jews murdered (>91%, Ponary/ 9th Fort); 185k Poles to Poland; 20k LLKS partisans killed; 132k exiled (Vesna/Priboi/ Osen)

(Continued from previous page)

Western Soviet Region (1926-1953AD)	1926AD	1941AD	1945AD	1947AD	1953AD	Umsiedlung, Shoah, Flight, Famine & 1948-51 Deportations
Reg. 4: Moldavian SSR (Chisinau, Tiraspol, Balti, Bender, Orhei)	2,04M	2,47M	2,08M	1,94M	2,52M	57k MASSR famine deaths (1933); 93,5k Germans out (1940); 22,6k-29,8k exiled (1941); 200-280k Shoah deaths; 115-200k died in 1946-47 famine; 35,8k Op. Yug (1949)
Reg. 5: Kaliningrad Oblast/ N. East Prussia (Kaliningrad, Sovetsk)	1,12M	1,22M	180k	340k	540k	950k Germans fled/died (1945); 35k died of hunger/typhus (1945-47); 102.405 Germans deported to SBZ (1947-48); >420k Russian/Belarusian settlers & Baltic Fleet in
Western Annexation Belt Total (Regions 1-5 Combined)	8,78M	9,68M	7,15M	7,55M	8,84M	Combined 1941-45 loss of -2,53M (-26,1%); >250k Baltic/Moldavian peasants deported in 1948-51 (Vesna, Priboi, Yug, Osen) to Siberia & Kazakhstan

Table 5. Demographic trajectories, wartime losses, the 1946AD - 1947AD famine and post-war deportations across the five western regions (1926AD - 1953AD).

Border Cleansings, Karelia and the Volga-Ural Republics

Pre-War Border Expulsions, the 1937AD Korean Deportation and the Great Terror

Between 1935AD and 1938AD, Soviet demographic policy shifted from class-based dekulakisation to pre-emptive ethnic cleansing of western and eastern border zones [4][12][22]. In the western border-zone expulsions of February-March 1935AD and January-September 1936AD, the NKVD deported ~42.000 Polish and German families (~195.000 persons, including the liquidation of the Marchlewski Polish National Raion and Pulin German National Raion in Zhytomyr/Volhynia, Region 10, and border raions of Region 7 in Belarus) to northern Kazakhstan and Siberia; simultaneously, in 1935-1936AD, ~27.000 to 45.000 Ingrian Finns (*Inkerilaiset*) were forcibly cleared from the Estonian and Finnish border raions of Leningrad Oblast (Region 17) and Karelia (Region 16) to Vologda, Western Siberia and Tajikistan [4][12].

In the Far East, under Sovnarkom and Central Committee Resolution No. 1428-326ss of 21 August 1937AD (signed by Stalin and Molotov), the entire ethnic Korean population (*Koryo-saram*) of Primorye and the Amur-Ussuri borderlands (Region 45: Posyet, Vladivostok, Spassk, Ussuriysk/Voroshilov and Khabarovsk border districts) was subjected to the first total nationality deportation in Soviet history [4][22]. Within eight weeks (September-October 1937AD), 124 echelons transported 36.442 Korean families (171.781 persons) across 6.000 kilometres to Uzbekistan (76.525) and Kazakhstan (95.256), where ~25k to 40k died of exposure and typhus during 1937-1938AD, while vacated Korean collective farms in Region 45 were

repopulated by demobilised Red Army men and Russian and Ukrainian settlers [4]. Concurrently, during the 1937-1938AD Great Terror, under NKVD Order No. 00447 ("kulak operation") and the "national operations" (Polish Order No. 00485, German Order No. 00439, and the Romanian, Harbinite, Latvian, Estonian, Finnish, Greek and Korean directives), ~1,57M people were arrested and 681.692 were executed in 1937-1938AD, striking disproportionately at borderland minorities in Regions 4, 7, 10, 14, 16, 17 and 45 and political exiles inside the Gulag [12][13].

Karelia and the White Sea-Baltic Canal (Region 16)

Region 16 (337.469 km2) illustrates the intersection of Gulag construction, ethnic purges, border annexations and wholesale population replacement [14][73]. The White Sea-Baltic Canal (*Belomorcanal/BBK*, 1931-1933AD) was constructed in twenty months (November 1931AD - August 1933AD) across 227 km from Lake Onega (Povenets) to the White Sea (Soroka/Belomorsk) by an average contingent of 107.900 *Belbaltlag* prisoners (with ~170k passing through the camp and ~12.000 to 25.000 officially recorded camp deaths), managed from Medvezhyegorsk (Region 16) [16][73]. *Belbaltlag* and *Segezhlag* subsequently built pulp-and-paper, aluminium and nickel complexes at Segezha, Nadvoitsy and Monchegorsk (*Severonikel* on the Kola Peninsula), while Murmansk expanded from 8.777 (1926AD) to 118.690 (1939AD), driving Region 16 from 860k (1926AD) to 1,39M (1939AD, including pre-war Finnish Viipuri/Vyborg province) (archived PDF) [14].

During the early 1930s ("Karelian Fever", 1930-1935AD), ~6.000 to 6.500 North American Finns from the United States and Canada alongside ~8.000 Red Finns from Finland were recruited by Karelian ASSR leader Edvard Gylling to modernise Karelian forestry around Petrozavodsk, Kondopoga and Uroszero. During the 1937-1938AD Great Terror, however, the NKVD executed Gylling, abolished Finnish national status in Karelia, and arrested or shot over 9.000 ethnic Finns in Karelia (~38% of all Great Terror victims in the republic despite Finns forming <3% of the population) [73]. Following the 1939-1940AD Winter War and the Moscow Peace Treaty (12 March 1940AD), the USSR annexed the Karelian Isthmus (Viipuri/Vyborg), Ladoga Karelia (Sortavala, Kakisalmi/Priozersk and Suojarvi) and Salla (~35.000 km2) and elevated Karelia on 31 March 1940AD into the 16th Union Republic as the Karelo-Finnish SSR [4][73]. Virtually the entire indigenous Finnish Karelian population (~422.000 people, >99% of the ceded territory's inhabitants) evacuated across the new border into Finland in March 1940AD rather than remain under Soviet rule. After ~260.000 Karelians returned during the 1941-1944AD Continuation War, they evacuated a second and final time (~407.000 total evacuees) upon the September 1944AD Moscow Armistice, leaving Vyborg and Sortavala empty of their pre-war population. Consequently, Region 16 fell from 1,39M (1939AD) to 1,12M (1941AD) and 680k (1945AD, -39,3% below 1941AD), before organised kolkhoz and timber resettlement from Belarus, Vologda, Central Russia and Ukraine restored it to 1,12M by 1953AD [4].

Komi, the Volga-Kama Republics and the Urals (Regions 18, 23, 24 and 34)

Across the northern and Volga-Ural autonomous republics of the RSFSR, Five-Year-Plan industrialisation and forced labour produced large demographic shifts (Figure 4 and Table 1). Elevated from the Komi (Zyryan) Autonomous Oblast to the Komi ASSR under the 5 December 1936AD Stalin Constitution, the Komi ASSR and Nenets National Okrug (Region 18) more than tripled from 240k in 1926AD to 430k in 1939AD, 560k in 1945AD and 750k in 1953AD (+212,5% over 1926AD - the only European USSR region to expand continuously throughout the 1941-1945AD war). Following the 1929AD OGPU Ukhta expedition, *Ukhtpechlag* (1932-1938AD) was split into *Vorkutlag* (mining Pechora coking coal at 67,5°N to replace occupied Donbas coal during the war), *Intalag* (Inta energy coal), *Ukhtizhemlag* (Ukhta oil and radium/gas) and *Sevzheldorlag* (which built the 1.191 km Kotlas-Pechora-Vorkuta North Pechora Railway, completed in December 1941AD at the cost of >30k prisoner lives) [13][16]. By 1953AD, Vorkuta (65k free residents plus 73k inmates in *Vorkutlag* and Special Camp No. 6 *Rechlag*, site of the July-August 1953AD Vorkuta Uprising,

where Baltic and Western Ukrainian political prisoners played a leading role), Ukhta (26k), Inta (24k) and Pechora (22k) had reduced ethnic Komi to a minority (~30%) inside their own republic.

In the Volga-Vyatka basin, the Chuvash, Mari, Mordovian and Udmurt ASSRs together with Gorky and Kirov Oblasts (Region 23) grew from 6,77M (1926AD) to 7,28M (1941AD) and stood at 6,95M in 1953AD. In the Mordovian ASSR (1934AD), rural 1933AD famine and out-migration were offset by the *Temlag/Dubravlag* camp complex at Yavas and Potma (~50k+ prisoners, including Special Camp No. 3 for political prisoners from 1948AD); the Udmurt ASSR (1934AD) centred on Izhevsk (63k in 1926AD to 176k in 1939AD to 245k in 1953AD), which produced over 11,1M rifles and carbines during 1941-1945AD; Gorky (*GAZ* automotive plant) jumped from 222k (1926AD) to 644k (1939AD) and 830k (1953AD); and northern Kirov Oblast hosted *Vyatlag* (~30k+ timber prisoners, including 1941AD Latvian and Estonian deportees) (archived PDF) [13][74]. Further east in the Tatar ASSR and Ulyanovsk-Penza (Region 24: Kazan growing from 179k in 1926AD to 398k in 1939AD and 560k in 1953AD) and the Great Ural Arsenal and Bashkir ASSR (Region 34: Ufa growing from 99k to 250k and 380k alongside Ishimbai, Tuymazy and Salavat/Novostroika), the discovery of the "Second Baku" (*Vtoroy Baku*) Volga-Ural oilfields (1932-1944AD) and the 1941-1942AD evacuation of 667+ defence factories lifted Region 34 from 9,1M (1926AD) to 11,9M (1941AD), 13,5M (1943AD) and 14,39M (1953AD, +58,1% over 1926AD), powered by ~350k+ mobilised Soviet German and minority *Trudarmiya* ("Labour Army") conscripts in Chelyabinsk (*Bakallag/Chelyabmetallurgstroy*), *Bogoslovlag* (Karpinsk/Krasnoturyinsk aluminium), *Tagillag* and Solikamsk (*Usollag*) (archived PDF) [75][76].

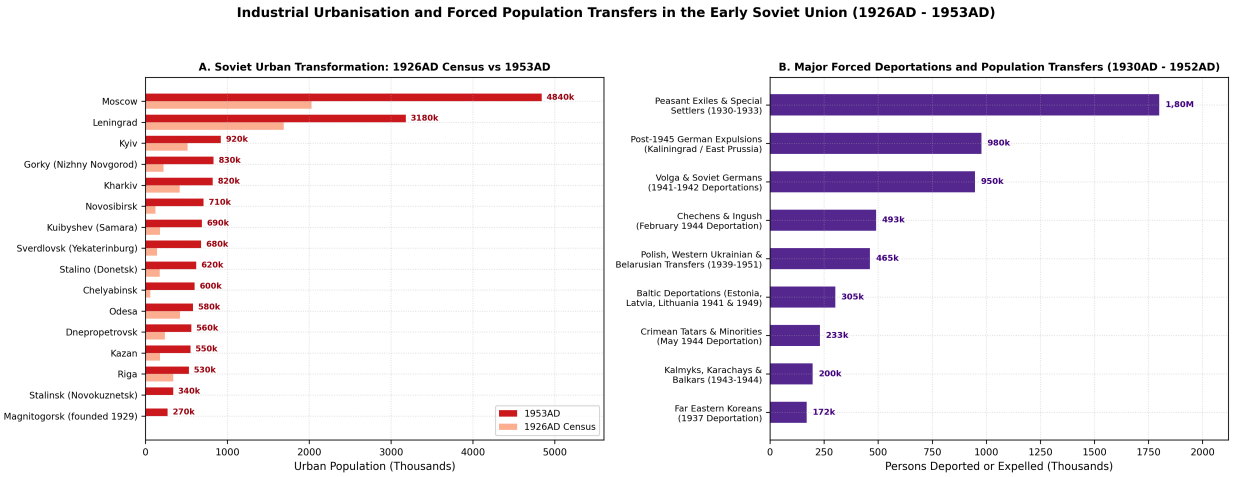


Figure 4. Urban population growth across major Soviet metropolises, industrial boomtowns, annexed ports and Gulag centres at 1926AD, 1939AD and 1953AD.

Wartime Ethnic Deportations and Republic Liquidations

Between August 1941AD and June 1944AD, Stalin, Beria and the State Defence Committee (*GKO*) carried out seven total ethnic deportations (*totalnye deportatsii "nakazannykh narodov"*), abolishing five autonomous republics and autonomous oblasts across the Lower Volga, Crimea and the North Caucasus and deporting their entire indigenous populations in sealed cattle cars to special settlements (*spetsposeleniya*) in Kazakhstan, Central Asia and Siberia (archived PDF; archived PDF) [4][6][21][22][77][78]. Our 45-region partition isolates each liquidated autonomous unit across Regions 15, 26, 28, 30, 31, 32 and 33 (Figure 3 and Table 6).

Under the Supreme Soviet Presidium Decree of 28 August 1941AD ("On the Resettlement of the Germans

Living in the Volga Districts"), the Volga German ASSR (Region 26, *ASSR Nemtsev Povolzhya*, founded in 1918/1924AD with its capital at Engels/Pokrovsk and cantonal centres at Marxstadt/Marks, Balzer/Krasnoarmeysk, Seelmann/Rovnoe, Kukkus and Pallasovka) was abolished on 7 September 1941AD, and its 22 cantons (n=22) were partitioned between Saratov Oblast (15 cantons) and Stalingrad Oblast (7 cantons) [4][43]. Between 3 and 20 September 1941AD, NKVD troops loaded 438.700 Volga Germans (virtually the entire ethnic German population of Region 26, alongside ~42k Germans from neighbouring Saratov and Stalingrad raions) into 188 freight echelons bound for Altai Krai (Region 38, ~95k), Novosibirsk and Omsk Oblasts (Region 35, ~195k), Krasnoyarsk Krai (Region 40, ~75k) and the Kazakh SSR [43][77]. Combined with the 1941-1942AD deportation of >450k Soviet Germans from Ukraine, Crimea, Transcaucasia and Leningrad (~950k wartime deportees) and the conscription of ~316k adult German men and women into NKVD *Trudarmiya* timber and construction camps in Regions 18, 34 and 37, total wartime German forced displacement reached ~1,2M [6][22]. As a direct result, Region 26 fell by -66,1% from 620k in June 1941AD to 210k in 1943AD and 250k in 1945AD (-59,7%), recovering only to 340k by 1953AD (-45,2% below 1941AD) as evacuated and resettled Russian and Ukrainian collective farmers only partially refilled the depopulated German steppes.

In the North Caucasus and Lower Volga, following the Supreme Soviet Decree of 12 October 1943AD, NKVD units on 2-5 November 1943AD deported 14.774 families (69.267 persons) of the Karachay Autonomous Oblast in Region 30 (capital Mikoyan-Shakhar, renamed Klukhori/Karachaevsk) in 34 echelons to the Kazakh (45.529) and Kirghiz (23.300) SSRs, where ~15k to 19k (~22%, including over 10k children) perished from typhus and malnutrition during 1943-1945AD [21][78]. The Karachay AO was abolished: its northern districts were absorbed into Stavropol Krai and the Cherkess AO, while its southern high-mountain Caucasus districts (Mikoyan-Shakhar and Uchkulan) were annexed to the Georgian SSR as Klukhorsky Raion until 1955AD [79]. Combined with wartime losses across Stavropol, Region 30 fell by -16,7% from 1,74M (1941AD) to 1,45M (1945AD). Seven weeks later, under the Supreme Soviet Decree of 27 December 1943AD, NKVD Chief Beria supervised Operation *Ulusy* (28-31 December 1943AD) in the Kalmyk ASSR (Region 28), in which 10.000 NKVD troops deported 26.359 Kalmyk families (93.139 persons, followed by ~6k Kalmyks from Rostov and Stalingrad oblasts and demobilised Red Army soldiers sent to the *Shirokovlag* hydro-camp) in 46 unheated winter cattle-car echelons to Altai Krai (Region 38), Omsk, Tyumen and Novosibirsk Oblasts (Regions 35-36) and Krasnoyarsk Krai (Regions 40-41), with ~3.500 Kalmyks sent in 1944AD to Far Eastern fishery brigades on Sakhalin and the Tatar Strait (Region 45) [4][21][77]. Over 16.500 Kalmyks (>17% of the deported nation) died in transit and during 1944-1945AD. The Kalmyk ASSR was abolished, its capital Elista was renamed Stepnoy, and its territory was partitioned among Astrakhan, Stalingrad and Rostov Oblasts and Stavropol Krai, causing Region 28 to fall by -64,9% from 185k (1941AD) to 65k (1945AD), reaching only 100k by 1953AD (-45,9% below 1941AD).

Under GKO Resolution No. 5073ss (31 January 1944AD), Beria, Kobulov, Serov and 119.000 NKVD and SMERSH troops launched Operation *Chechevitsa* ("Lentil") in the Chechen-Ingush ASSR (Region 32) at dawn on 23 February 1944AD (Red Army Day) [4][21][22]. Using ~12.000 Lend-Lease Studebaker trucks to clear snowbound mountain *auls* and 180 freight echelons (14.200 wagons), the NKVD deported 478.479 Vainakhs (387.229 Chechens and 91.250 Ingush) within seven days; including Chechens and Ingush deported from other republics and demobilised from the Red Army, the total registered contingent reached 493.269 to 496.460 [6][21]. In the high-mountain village of Khaibakh (Galanchozhsky Raion), on 27 February 1944AD, NKVD officers under M. Gveshiani locked ~650 to 700 women, children and elderly residents unable to march through deep snow inside a collective-farm stable and burned them alive [4]. Deported to the Kazakh SSR (~411k) and Kirghiz SSR (~85k), the Chechens and Ingush suffered severe typhus, exposure and starvation mortality: NKVD special-settlement records document 123.000 to 144.704 deaths between 1944AD and 1948AD (23,7% to 25% of the Chechen and Ingush nations) [6][78]. On 7 March 1944AD, the Chechen-Ingush ASSR was abolished and divided into four parts: the central and northern

plains around Grozny and the Sunzha and Terek valleys became Grozny Oblast of the RSFSR; Prigorodny Raion (East Vladikavkaz), Nazran, Malgobek and Achkhoy-Martan were transferred to the North Ossetian ASSR (Region 31, with Vladikavkaz/Ordzhonikidze renamed Dzaudzhikau); the eastern mountain districts (Vedeno, Nozhay-Yurt, Sayasan, Kurchaloy, Cheberloy and Sharoy) were annexed to the Dagestan ASSR (Region 33); and the southern Itum-Kale gorge was annexed to the Georgian SSR (Akhalkhevi Raion) [79]. Despite organised Slavic resettlement into the Grozny oilfields and Sunzha valley, Region 32 fell by -57% from 790k (1941AD) to 340k (1945AD), reaching only 490k in 1953AD (-38% below 1941AD).

Immediately after Operation *Chechevitsa*, on 8-9 March 1944AD, 19.000 NKVD troops deported the entire Balkar population (37.713 persons) from the high-mountain Baksan, Chegem, Cherek and Khulam-Bezengi gorges of the Kabardino-Balkar ASSR (Region 31) in 14 echelons to Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan, where ~22% died during 1944-1948AD [21][78]. By Decree of 8 April 1944AD, the republic was renamed the Kabardian ASSR (capital Nalchik), and its upper Baksan and Mount Elbrus territories were ceded to the Georgian SSR (Upper Svanetia). Meanwhile, the North Ossetian ASSR absorbed Ingush Prigorodny Raion and was resettled with ~45k Ossetians from both North Ossetia and South Ossetia/Georgia, resulting in Region 31 declining by -18,3% from 930k (1941AD) to 760k (1945AD) before recovering to 930k by 1953AD [79]. In the neighbouring Dagestan ASSR (Region 33), the NKVD during Operation *Chechevitsa* (23-29 February 1944AD) deported the entire Aukhovsky (Akkin) Chechen population (14.542 persons) from Aukhovsky Raion (founded in October 1943AD in northwestern Dagestan around Khasavyurt) to Kazakhstan (archived PDF) [34][79]. To erase Chechen presence and secure the annexed eastern Chechen mountain districts (Vedeno, Nozhay-Yurt, Sayasan and Kurchaloy), Sovnarkom Resolution No. 255-74ss (11 March 1944AD) ordered the compulsory internal resettlement of ~55.000 to 65.000 Dagestani highlanders: Aukhovsky Raion was renamed Novolaksky Raion and settled with ~6.000 to 8.000 mountain Laks from Kuli and Laksky raions (Kazi-Kumukh), while ~50.000 Avars, Andi-Tsez peoples and Dargins were marched from central Dagestan into the vacated Chechen villages (renamed Andalal, Rikvani, Ritlyab and Shuragatl). Lacking shelter, tools or immunity to lowland malaria and typhus, up to 15-20% of the forcibly resettled Dagestani mountaineers perished between 1944AD and 1947AD, contributing alongside wartime military losses to Region 33 falling by -20,9% from 860k (1941AD) to 680k (1945AD, and 760k in 1953AD) [34].

In Crimea (Region 15), following the liberation of Sevastopol, GKO Resolution No. 5859ss (11 May 1944AD) ordered the total deportation of the Crimean Tatars [4][21]. On 18-20 May 1944AD, 32.000 NKVD troops deported 191.044 Crimean Tatars (47.000 families, including ~6k deported from the Kerch peninsula in April) in 67 echelons to the Uzbek SSR (151.604), the Mari ASSR (Region 23, ~8,5k), Molotov and Sverdlovsk Oblasts (Region 34, ~20k) and Kostroma and Gorky timber camps, where ~27k to 44k (15-22%) died during 1944-1948AD [6][22]. Five weeks later, under GKO Resolution No. 5984ss (2 June 1944AD), on 24-27 June 1944AD the NKVD deported ~41.854 additional Crimean minorities: 15.040 Crimean Greeks, 12.422 Bulgarians, 9.621 Armenians and ~4.770 Germans, Italians and foreign nationals (following the August 1941AD deportation of ~53.000 Crimean Germans). Combined with the 250-day Siege of Sevastopol (1941-1942AD) and the German murder of ~40.000 Crimean Jews and Krymchaks, Region 15 fell by -49,2% from 1,18M (1941AD) to 600k (1945AD). On 30 June 1945AD, the Crimean ASSR was downgraded to Crimean Oblast, Tatar, Greek and German toponyms (*Karasubazar* to Belogorsk) were Russified, and organised kolkhoz resettlement brought >350.000 Russian and Ukrainian settlers from Voronezh, Kursk, Oryol, Bryansk, Rostov, Gorky and Ukraine, raising Region 15 to 980k by 1953AD (-16,9% below 1941AD) [4].

Liquidated ASSR/ Borderland & Region	Date	Deported Headcount	1941 to 1945 to 1953	Exile Destinations, Excess Mortality & Territorial Liquidation
Reg. 26: Volga German ASSR (Engels, Marxstadt, Balzer)	Aug-Sept 1941AD	438.700 (950k+ all USSR)	620k to 250k to 340k	To Altai (Reg. 38), Novosibirsk/Omsk (Reg. 35), Krasnoyarsk (Reg. 40) & Kazakhstan; ASSR split between Saratov & Stalingrad; 316k in Trudarmiya
Reg. 30: Karachay AO in Stavropol Krai (Mikoyan-Shakhar)	2-5 Nov 1943AD	69.267 Karachays	1,74M to 1,45M to 1,7M	To Kazakh & Kirghiz SSRs (22% died 1943-45); AO abolished, southern mountain gorges ceded to Georgian SSR as Klukhorsky Raion
Reg. 28: Kalmyk ASSR (Elista to Stepnoy, Operation Ulusy)	28-31 Dec 1943AD	93.139 Kalmyks (+6k)	185k to 65k to 100k	To Altai (Reg. 38), Omsk/ Novosibirsk (Reg. 35), Krasnoyarsk (Reg. 40) & Sakhalin fisheries (>17% died); ASSR absorbed into Astrakhan Oblast
Reg. 32: Chechen-Ingush ASSR to Grozny Oblast (Op. Chechevitsa)	23-29 Feb 1944AD	493.269 Chechens & Ingush	790k to 340k to 490k	To Kazakh (411k) & Kirghiz (85k) SSRs (24% died, >123k deaths + Khaibakh massacre); ASSR split into Grozny Oblast, Prigorodny (N. Ossetia) & Dagestan
Reg. 31: Kabardino-Balkar ASSR to Kabardian ASSR (Nalchik)	8-9 Mar 1944AD	37.713 Balkars	930k to 760k to 930k	To Kazakh & Kirghiz SSRs (22% died); renamed Kabardian ASSR; upper Baksan & Mount Elbrus ceded to Georgian SSR
Reg. 33: Dagestan ASSR (Aukhovsky Raion to Novolaksky Raion)	Feb-May 1944AD	14.542 Akkin (+55k moved)	860k to 680k to 760k	Akkin Chechens deported to Kazakhstan; 6k Laks moved into Novolaksky Raion & 50k Avars/Dargins into annexed Chechen mountain raions
Reg. 15: Crimean ASSR to Crimean Oblast (Simferopol, Bakhchisaray)	May-June 1944AD	191.044 Tatars + 41.854 min.	1,18M to 600k to 980k	Tatars, Greeks (15k), Bulgarians (12,4k) & Armenians (9,6k) to Uzbekistan, Mari ASSR & Urals; downgraded to Crimean Oblast; >350k Slavic settlers in

(Continued from previous page)

Liquidated ASSR/ Borderland & Region	Date	Deported Headcount	1941 to 1945 to 1953	Exile Destinations, Excess Mortality & Territorial Liquidation
Reg. 45: Primorye & Far East Border Zone (Soviet Koreans)	Sept-Oct 1937AD	171.781 Soviet Koreans	2,56M to 2,79M to 3,64M	124 echelons from Vladivostok/Posyet to Uzbekistan (76,5k) & Kazakhstan (95,3k); border kolkhozes repopulated by Red Army settlers
Reg. 16 & 17: Leningrad & Karelia (Ingrian Finns & Karelians)	1935-44AD	89k Ingrian + 422k evacuated	Reg. 16: 1,12M to 680k to 1,12M	Ingrian Finns deported to Yakutia (Lena Delta, Reg. 43) & Siberia; 422k Finnish Karelians evacuated to Finland in 1940/1944; Karelo-Finnish SSR repopulated
Reg. 1-4: Baltic SSRs & Moldavian SSR (1941 + Vesna/ Priboi/Yug)	1941 & 1948-51AD	66k (1941) + 232k (1948-51)	Reg. 1-4: 8,46M to 6,97M to 8,3M	Vesna (40-48k LT), Priboi (20,7k EE + 42,1k LV + 29,2k LT), Yug (35,8k MD) & Osen (16,2k LT) deported to Irkutsk, Krasnoyarsk, Omsk, Tomsk, Amur & Kurgan
Reg. 6, 8 & 9: W. Belarus, Galicia-Volhynia & Bukovina (OUN-UPA)	1940-41 & 44-52AD	320k (1940-41) + 203k OUN	Reg. 8: 7,74M to 5,18M to 5,66M	Polish citizens deported 1940-41; 1,08M Poles exchanged 1944-46; 203k W. Ukrainians deported to Siberia/Vorkuta/Kolyma (Op. Zapad 1947)
Total Punished Peoples & Special Settlers (1937-1953AD)	1937-1953AD	3,55M ethnic/ border exiles	2.753.356 in exile (Jan 1953)	On 1 Jan 1953AD, MVD special settlements held 2.753.356 exiles (1.224.931 Germans, 498.452 N. Caucasians, 204.698 Crimean, 175.063 OUN, 173k Baltic/MD)

Table 6. Total ethnic deportations, liquidated autonomous republics, western borderland operations and regional trajectories from 1937AD to 1953AD.

Siberia, the Far East and the Second World War

Siberia and the Far East (Regions 35 to 45)

A key feature of our 45-region partition is the division of Siberia and the Far East into eleven regions (n=11, Regions 35-45, 12.853.253 km2) that separate the urbanising Trans-Siberian industrial and evacuation corridor (Regions 35, 37, 38, 40 and 45) from the northern special-settlement and polar Gulag zones (Regions 36, 41 and 44) and the indigenous Siberian autonomous republics and oblasts (Regions 39, 42 and 43) (Table 7).

Spanning 3,06M km2, the Yakut ASSR (Region 43) grew from 285k in 1926AD to 415k in 1939AD and 425k in 1941AD as the Aldan (Nezametny) and Allakh-Yun (*Dzhugdzhurlag*) goldfields drew tens of thousands of Russian miners and special settlers, reducing the indigenous Sakha (Yakut) share of the republic's population from 81,6% (1926AD) to 56,5% (1939AD) [80]. During the Great Patriotic War, Region 43 contracted from 425k (1941AD) to 400k (1943-1945AD) due to military conscription (~62k mobilised), rural famine and the August-September 1942AD Churapcha Tragedy (*Churapchinskaya tragediya*) [80]: under the Yakut VKP(b) Obkom resolution of 11 August 1942AD (signed by I. Vinokurov), 4.988 Sakha collective farmers (1.781 households from 41 drought-stricken *alaas* cattle-breeding kolkhozes in Churapcha Ulus) were forcibly marched to the Lena River and shipped by barge 1.500+ km north of the Arctic Circle to unprepared fishing camps in Kobyaysky (2.023), Zhigansky (1.178) and Bulunsky (1.787) uluses to supply fish for the front. Stripped of livestock and placed on freezing tundra without nets, winter housing or rations, 1.748 Churapcha deportees (>35% of the resettled population) perished from starvation and scurvy between 1942AD and 1944AD before the survivors were permitted to return in 1944-1946AD [80]. Concurrently, in 1942AD, the NKVD deported ~12.000 Leningrad Ingrian Finns (evacuated across Lake Ladoga from Region 17), Volga Germans (Region 26) and June 1941AD Lithuanian deportees (Region 3) to the treeless islands of the Arctic Lena Delta (Trofimovsk, Bykov Mys, Tit-Ary and Stolbovoy at 72-73°N), where ice-block barracks and scurvy killed over 40% of the exiles during the winter of 1942-1943AD [4][80]. Post-war expansion of *Yanastroy*/*Dalstroy* tin and gold camps at Ust-Nera (Oymyakon) and Khandyga raised Region 43 to 470k by 1953AD.

In the Buryat-Mongol ASSR and Chita/Transbaikalia (Region 42, founded in 1923AD with its capital at Verkhneudinsk, renamed Ulan-Ude in 1934AD), cattle collectivisation and anti-Buddhist campaigns (1929-1932AD, which destroyed >60% of the republic's livestock and closed all 44 *datsans*, n=44) provoked armed uprisings in Mukhorshibir, Bichura and Zakamensk and the flight of ~35.000 Buryats and Transbaikal Old Believers (*Semeiskie*) across the border into Mongolia and Manchuria. At the height of the Great Terror, on 26 September 1937AD, the Central Executive Committee of the USSR partitioned the Buryat-Mongol ASSR, detaching six western Buryat *aimaks* (Alarsky, Bokhansky, Ekhirit-Bulagatsky and Nukutsky) into Irkutsk Oblast (Region 40) as the Ust-Orda Buryat National Okrug and two eastern *aimaks* (Aginsky and Ulan-Ononsky) into Chita Oblast as the Agin-Buryat National Okrug, while NKVD officers executed First Secretary Mikhey Yerbanov and the Buryat intellectual elite on charges of "Pan-Mongolist Japanese espionage" [12]. Simultaneously, Five-Year-Plan construction of the Ulan-Ude Locomotive and Wagon Works (*UULVRZ*) and Aircraft Plant No. 99 propelled Ulan-Ude from 28.918 (1926AD) to 125.690 (1939AD) and 158.000 (1953AD), while NKVD *Dzhidlag* prisoners (joined in 1948AD by Lithuanian Operation *Vesna* timber exiles) mined tungsten and molybdenum at Gorodok (Zakamensk) and *Bamlag*/*Zabaikallag* prisoners expanded the Transbaikal railway and gold and tin mines across Chita Oblast, carrying Region 42 from 1,05M (1926AD) to 1,97M (1953AD, +87,6%).

Across the Altai-Sayan autonomous belt (Region 39: 490k in 1926AD to 960k in 1953AD, +95,9%), the Khakass Autonomous Oblast (established 20 October 1930AD, capital Abakan: 3,1k in 1926AD to 36,6k in 1939AD and 52k in 1953AD) became a major reception zone for dekulakised peasants (1930-1933AD), Volga Germans (1941AD), Kalmyks (1944AD) and Baltic and Western Ukrainian deportees (1944-1949AD) in the Chernogorsk coal basin and *Balyksinsk*/*Sarala* goldfields, reducing ethnic Khakass from 53% (1926AD) to 16,8% (1939AD) of their oblast's population. In the Oyrot Autonomous Oblast (founded in 1922AD),

collectivisation and the 1933AD famine triggered flight into Xinjiang; on 7 January 1948AD, during late Stalinist ideological campaigns against “bourgeois-nationalist Oyrot epics”, the oblast was renamed Gorno-Altai Autonomous Oblast and its capital *Oyrot-Tura* became Gorno-Altaysk. On 11 October 1944AD, the formerly independent Tuvan People’s Republic (*Tannu-Tuva*, 170.500 km2, capital Kyzyl, population ~95.000, ~81% Tuvan nomadic herders plus Russian settlers) was annexed by Presidium Decree as the Tuva Autonomous Oblast of the RSFSR, followed by forced collectivisation of Tuvan *arats* during 1948-1953AD [4].

Along the West Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine (Region 35: Tyumen, Kurgan, Omsk, Novosibirsk and Tomsk), the population rose from 3,88M (1926AD) to 5,08M (1941AD), surged to 5,88M (1943AD) as 322+ evacuated defence, optical and aviation plants settled in Novosibirsk (120k to 404k to 710k) and Omsk (162k to 289k to 490k), absorbed tens of thousands of Estonian, Latvian and Moldavian *Priboi* and *Yug* deportees in 1949AD across Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk, Kurgan and Tyumen, and reached 6,34M in 1953AD (+63,4%) (archived PDF; archived PDF) [18][35][81]. In the Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine and *Siblag* (Region 37: Kemerovo Oblast, detached 26 January 1943AD), the population more than tripled from 750k (1926AD) to 1,82M (1941AD), 2,15M (1943AD) and 2,52M (1953AD, +236%), anchored by Stalinsk/Novokuznetsk (3,9k to 166k to 315k), Prokopyevsk (11k to 107k to 240k) and Kemerovo (22k to 133k to 235k), while assimilating ~78k *Siblag* prisoners, >100k Volga German *Trudarmiya* coal miners and the liquidated Mountain Shoria (*Gornaya Shoriya*) National Raion (abolished in 1939AD, where Shor iron-smelters fell from >50% to <6%). To the south, Altai Krai (Region 38: Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Biysk and Slavgorod) grew from 2,28M (1926AD) to 2,68M (1941AD), jumped to 3,05M (1943AD) with the arrival of ~95k deported Volga Germans, ~22k Kalmyks, 1941AD Lithuanian and 1949AD Moldavian exiles, Leningrad evacuees and the evacuated Kharkiv Tractor Plant at Rubtsovsk (*Altai Tractor Plant*), and reached 3,24M in 1953AD (+42,1%) (archived PDF) [82].

In Eastern Siberia and the Far North, the East Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor of Krasnoyarsk (*Kraslag*) and Irkutsk-Tayshet (*Ozerlag*) (Region 40) more than doubled from 1,92M (1926AD) to 3,95M (1953AD, +105,7%), receiving the largest concentrations of 1948-1951AD Lithuanian, Estonian and Western Ukrainian deportees alongside MVD Special Camp No. 7 (*Ozerlag* at Tayshet, ~37k political prisoners) and *Angarstroy* (115k prisoners) building the western Baikal-Amur Mainline and early Angarsk (archived PDF; archived PDF) [63][77]. The Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag and Tundra (Region 41: *Norillag*, Igarka, Taymyr and Evenkia) surged by +354,5% from 110k (1926AD) to 500k (1953AD). Centred on Norilsk (69,3°N), *Norillag* (1935-1956AD, 72.500 inmates plus Special Camp No. 2 *Gorlag*, where Baltic and Ukrainian political prisoners led the May-August 1953AD Norilsk Uprising) produced over 35% of Soviet nickel alongside copper, cobalt and platinum, while ~25k kulak and Lithuanian and Finnish exiles worked at Igarka and in the Taymyr (Dolgan-Nenets) and Evenki National Okrugs (founded December 1930AD) [13][16].

In the Extreme Northeast, the *Dalstroy* Gulag Complex of Kolyma-Magadan (*Sevvostlag*), Chukotka and Kamchatka (Region 44) expanded twelvefold (+1.100%) from 35k (1926AD) to 255k (1941AD) and 420k (1953AD, detached as Magadan Oblast in December 1953AD). Established in November 1931AD under Eduard Berzin, the NKVD *Dalstroy* trust and *Sevvostlag* (~170k-200k peak inmates, plus Special Camp No. 5 *Berlag*) shipped ~740.000 prisoners by steamer from Vladivostok and Nakhodka to Nagaevo Bay (Magadan, 55k in 1953AD) to build the 2.000 km Kolyma Highway and mine gold, tin and uranium at Susuman, Yagodnoye, Butugychag and Pevek (Chaun-Chukotka), at the cost of ~130.000 to 150.000 prisoner deaths [13][16]. Finally, the Southern Far East (Region 45: Amur, the Jewish AO *Birobidzhan*, Khabarovsk, Primorye and post-1945AD South Sakhalin and the Kurils) grew more than threefold (+256,9%) from 1,02M (1926AD) to 2,56M (1941AD) and 3,64M (1953AD), receiving ~17k Latvian *Priboi* deportees in Amur Oblast (1949AD) alongside *Bamlag* (260k prisoners at Svobodny), Komsomolsk-on-Amur (0,3k to 71k to 160k), the Jewish Autonomous Oblast (Birobidzhan, established 7 May 1934AD, 108,9k in 1939AD) and

post-August 1945AD Southern Sakhalin (*Karafuto* to Yuzhno-Sakhalinsk) and the Kurils, where ~290.000 to 400.000 Japanese civilians were repatriated (1946-1949AD, leaving ~28k-43k stateless Sakhalin Koreans) and replaced by >350.000 Soviet settlers [4][12][18].

Siberian/Far East Region & Autonomous Unit	1926AD	1939AD	1945AD	1953AD	1926-53	Key Gulag Complexes, Deportee Inflows & Indigenous Republic Shocks
Reg. 35: W. Siberian Trans-Siberian Spine (Omsk, Novosibirsk, Tomsk, Kurgan)	3,88M	4,82M	5,55M	6,34M	+63,4%	322+ evacuated plants; 195k Volga German/ Kalmyk & 1949 Estonian/Latvian/ Moldavian Priboi-Yug exiles
Reg. 36: Ob-Irtysh Special-Settlement Taiga (Narym/ Nazino, Yugra, Yamal)	360k	680k	750k	820k	+127,8%	265k kulak exiles in Narym & Ostyak-Vogul/ Yamal Okrugs (1930); May 1933 Nazino tragedy (>4k died)
Reg. 37: Kuzbass Coal-Steel Combine & Siblag (Kemerovo Oblast 1943AD)	750k	1,68M	2,05M	2,52M	+236%	Stalinsk (315k), Prokopyevsk (240k), Kemerovo (235k); Siblag (78k), Trudarmiya; Mountain Shoria AO liquidated
Reg. 38: Altai Krai Deportee & Grain Hub (Barnaul, Rubtsovsk, Slavgorod)	2,28M	2,56M	2,86M	3,24M	+42,1%	Received 95k Volga Germans, 22k Kalmyks, 1941/49 Baltic-Moldavian exiles & Rubtsovsk/Barnaul plants
Reg. 39: Oyrot/ Gorno-Altai AO, Khakass AO & Tuva AO (1944AD Annex.)	490k	740k	810k	960k	+95,9%	Khakassia kulak/ German mines; Oyrot AO renamed Gorno-Altai AO (1948); Tannu-Tuva annexed Oct 1944 (95k)
Reg. 40: E. Siberian Trans-Siberian: Krasnoyarsk (Kraslag) & Irkutsk (Ozerlag)	1,92M	2,88M	3,32M	3,95M	+105,7%	Kraslag & Irkutsk timber exiles (1948-51 Vesna/Priboi); Tayshet Ozerlag (37k) & Angarstroy (115k)
Reg. 41: Yenisei-Taymyr Polar Gulag: Norillag (Norilsk), Igarka & Evenkia	110k	260k	390k	500k	+354,5%	Norillag/Gorlag (72,5k inmates, 1953 uprising) built Norilsk (78k); Igarka Lithuanian/ Finnish exiles

(Continued from previous page)

Siberian/Far East Region & Autonomous Unit	1926AD	1939AD	1945AD	1953AD	1926-53	Key Gulag Complexes, Deportee Inflows & Indigenous Republic Shocks
Reg. 42: Buryat-Mongol ASSR (1937 Split) & Chita/ Transbaikalia (Bamlag)	1,05M	1,64M	1,68M	1,97M	+87,6%	1929-32 flight; Sept 1937 split of Ust-Orda & Agin-Buryat Okrugs; Dzhidlag tungsten; Ulan-Ude 158k
Reg. 43: Yakut ASSR (Aldan Gold, 1942 Churapcha Tragedy & Lena Delta)	285k	415k	400k	470k	+64,9%	Aldan gold; Aug 1942 Churapcha tragedy (1.748 of 4.988 Sakha died in Arctic); Lena Delta Finnish/Baltic exiles
Reg. 44: Dalstroy Extreme NE Gulag: Kolyma-Magadan, Chukotka, Kamchatka	35k	205k	320k	420k	+1.100%	Dalstroy/Sevvostlag (740k shipped, 140k died) built Magadan (55k), Kolyma Highway, Susuman & Pevek
Reg. 45: S. Far East: Amur, Birobidzhan, Primorye (1937) & S. Sakhalin	1,02M	2,24M	2,79M	3,64M	+256,9%	171,8k Koreans deported (1937); Birobidzhan Jewish AO (1934); 1949 Latvian Priboi in Amur; S. Sakhalin (1945)
Total Siberian & Far Eastern Belt (Regions 35-45 Combined)	12,18M	18,12M	20,92M	24,83M	+103,9%	Doubled from 12,18M (1926AD) to 24,83M (1953AD) via Five-Year-Plan industry, evacuation, Gulag & exile

Table 7. Demographic trajectories, Gulag complexes, special settlements and indigenous autonomous shifts across the eleven Siberian regions (1926AD - 1953AD).

Wartime Losses, the Siege of Leningrad and the 1946-1947AD Famine

Across the western and southern regions of our 45-region partition (Regions 1-17, 21, 22, 27 and 29), the Great Patriotic War (1941-1945AD), the Holocaust, post-war population exchanges (1944-1948AD) and the 1946-1947AD famine left deep demographic scars (Table 8). Occupied from June 1941AD to July 1944AD, the Byelorussian SSR (Region 6: Western Belarus and Region 7: Eastern BSSR) lost 2,2M to 2,5M inhabitants (~25% of its population), including ~750k to 800k Jews murdered in the Minsk Ghetto (~100k), Maly Trostenets, Brest/Bronnaya Gora (~50k), Grodno, Pinsk, Vitebsk, Mogilev and Gomel, and 628 villages (n=628, such as Khatyn) burned with all inhabitants (archived PDF; archived PDF) [23][37][83]. Region 7 fell by -28,5% from 5,85M (1941AD) to 4,18M (1945AD, and 4,89M in 1953AD), while Region 6 dropped by -28,1% from 2,95M (1941AD) to 2,12M (1945AD, and 2,31M in 1953AD) as ~274.200 ethnic Poles

were transferred to Poland under the 1944-1946AD Lublin treaties.

In the Ukrainian SSR (Regions 8-14), the combined population across Regions 8-15 fell by -11,41M (-27,5%) from 41,56M (1941AD) to 30,15M (1945AD), driven by ~6,8M to 8M war deaths (including ~1,5M to 1,6M Holocaust victims at Babyn Yar in Kyiv 33.771, Kamianets-Podilskyi 23.600, Lviv/Janowska and Belzec, Drobytsky Yar in Kharkiv, and Romanian-occupied Odesa and Transnistria), 2,4M *Ostarbeiter* deportations and eastern evacuation (archived PDF) [23][41][84]. In Galicia and Volhynia (Region 8: 7,74M in 1941AD to 5,18M in 1945AD, -33,1%), the Holocaust (~700k murdered) was followed by the 1944-1946AD Polish-Ukrainian population exchange (~810.000 Poles transferred from Western Ukraine to Poland and ~482.800 Ukrainians transferred from Poland into Ukraine, plus ~140k Ukrainians deported inside Poland during 1947AD *Operation Vistula*) and the NKVD deportation of ~203.000 Western Ukrainians accused of aiding the OUN-UPA insurgency (culminating in Operation *Zapad* in October 1947AD, which exiled 77.791 people in three days to Karaganda, Omsk, Kemerovo and Vorkuta) [4][6][28]. In Northern Bukovina, Budjak and Transcarpathia (Region 9: 2,78M in 1941AD to 1,92M in 1945AD), Transcarpathia (Zakarpattia/Uzhhorod) was ceded by Czechoslovakia on 29 June 1945AD [4].

Separated from Kaliningrad Oblast (Region 5), Leningrad, Novgorod and Pskov Oblasts (Region 17) record the demographic shock of the 872-day Siege of Leningrad (8 September 1941AD - 27 January 1944AD) and the Wehrmacht occupation of Novgorod and Pskov (archived PDF; archived PDF) [85][86][87]. Between September 1941AD and January 1944AD, 800.000 to 1.000.000 civilians starved or froze to death inside Leningrad while 1,74M residents (including ~89k Leningrad Germans and Ingrian Finns deported to Siberia and the Lena Delta) were evacuated across Lake Ladoga's *Road of Life*, shrinking the city from 3,19M (1939AD) to 546k in January 1944AD (920k by late 1945AD), while Novgorod (40k in 1939AD to fewer than 3k civilians at liberation in January 1944AD, and 19k in 1945AD) and Staraya Russa were reduced to rubble. Consequently, Region 17 fell by -56,5% from 6,96M in June 1941AD to 3,03M in 1943AD, recovering via re-evacuation and the 1944-1945AD border transfers of Ivangorod and Pechory (from Estonia) and Pytalovo/Abrene (from Latvia) to 4,34M in 1945AD (-37,6%) and 5,49M in 1953AD (-21,1% below 1941AD, and further battered politically during the 1949-1950AD "Leningrad Affair").

Along the Smolensk-Rzhev-Vyazma-Bryansk axis, the Upper Volga and Western Front (Region 21) dropped by -25,8% (13,28M in 1941AD to 9,85M in 1945AD, and 10,79M in 1953AD); the Central Black-Earth Belt of Voronezh, Kursk and Oryol (Region 22) fell by -25,3% (13,85M to 10,35M); and Saratov, Stalingrad and Astrakhan (Region 27) fell by -19,3% (4,25M to 3,43M, with Stalingrad reduced from 445k to 32k in February 1943AD). Immediately after the war, the severe 1946AD drought across Moldavia, Ukraine, the Central Black-Earth Belt, the Lower Volga and West Siberia - compounded by 17,5M tonnes of state grain procurements, grain exports and the September 1946AD removal of 27,5M rural inhabitants from state bread rationing - triggered the 1946-1947AD Soviet Famine. Total excess deaths reached 1M to 1,5M: 115k-200k in the Moldavian SSR Region 4 (2,08M in 1945AD to 1,94M in 1947AD), ~300k-500k across Ukraine Regions 9, 10, 11 and 14 (Region 11: 6,75M to 6,72M) and ~500k-700k across Russia Regions 21, 22, 27, 29, 35 and 38 (Region 22: 10,35M to 10,25M), before post-war recovery carried the 45-region total to 165,35M in March 1953AD (archived PDF; archived PDF) [26][27][67][81][82].

Wartime Front/ Annexation/Famine Zone	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD	Major Wartime Shocks, Holocaust, Population Exchanges & Post-War Famine
Reg. 1-3: Baltic SSRs (Estonia, Latvia & Lithuania)	5,99M	5,38M	4,89M	5,78M	266k Jews murdered (Ponary, 9th Fort, Rumbula); 270k fled West; 185k Vilnius Poles out; 196k exiled (1948-51)

(Continued from previous page)

Wartime Front/ Annexation/Famine Zone	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD	Major Wartime Shocks, Holocaust, Population Exchanges & Post-War Famine
Reg. 4 & 5: Moldavian SSR (1947 Famine) & Kaliningrad Oblast	3,69M	3,27M	2,26M	3,06M	200-280k Bessarabian/ Transnistrian Shoah; 115-200k Moldavian famine deaths (1,94M in 1947); 102,4k Germans out of Reg. 5
Reg. 6 & 7: Byelorussian SSR (Western & Eastern Belarus)	8,8M	6,5M	6,3M	7,2M	2,2-2,5M dead (25%); 628 villages burned (Khatyn); 800k Jews murdered; 274,2k Poles transferred to Poland
Reg. 8 & 9: Western Ukraine (Galicia, Volhynia, Bukovina, Transcarpathia)	10,52M	8,2M	7,1M	7,75M	700k Jews murdered; 810k Poles out/482,8k Ukrainians in; 203k OUN-UPA deportees; Transcarpathia annexed 1945
Reg. 10 & 11: Right-Bank & Left-Bank Ukraine (Kyiv, Kharkiv, Poltava)	16,83M	12,99M	12,7M	14,08M	Babyn Yar (33.771 shot Sept 1941), Drobytsky Yar; heavy Ostarbeiter deportations; 1946-47 famine in Reg. 10-11
Reg. 12, 13 & 14: Dnieper Bend, Donbas & Black Sea Steppe (Odesa)	13,03M	9,26M	9,75M	12,67M	1941 factory evacuation; Romanian Transnistria (240k Shoah deaths in Reg. 10/14); Donbas rebuilt to 5,42M (+1,9%)
Reg. 17: Leningrad Siege Metropolis, Novgorod & Pskov Oblasts	6,96M	3,03M	4,34M	5,49M	800k-1M Leningrad blockade deaths + 1,74M evacuated (-56,5% by 1943); Novgorod/Pskov ruin; Pechory/Pytalovo added
Reg. 21 & 22: Western Front (Smolensk, Rzhev) & Central Black-Earth	27,13M	20,6M	20,2M	21,94M	Severe combat/occupation ruin at Smolensk, Rzhev, Vyazma, Bryansk, Oryol & Voronezh; 1947 famine drop
Reg. 27 & 29: Stalingrad Front, Lower Volga, Rostov & Kuban	11,49M	9,3M	9,53M	11,16M	Battle of Stalingrad (445k to 32k in Feb 1943); Zmievskaya Balka Shoah (27k in Rostov); Kuban front
Reg. 25 & 34: Kuibyshev Wartime Capital & Great Ural Arsenal	16,05M	17,95M	16,9M	19,07M	Received >800 evacuated factories & >2,5M evacuees; Tankograd (Chelyabinsk), Uralmash, Tagil & Kuibyshev boomed

(Continued from previous page)

Wartime Front/ Annexation/Famine Zone	1941AD	1943AD	1945AD	1953AD	Major Wartime Shocks, Holocaust, Population Exchanges & Post-War Famine
All 45 Regions Combined (incl. 146,24M in 1947AD Famine Year)	172,58M	146,48M	142,62M	165,35M	Net 1941-45 drop of -29,96M (-17,4%); 1-1,5M died in 1946-47 famine; spliced at 165,35M (1953AD) with post-Stalin epoch

Table 8. Great Patriotic War occupation losses, the Holocaust, Leningrad siege mortality and the 1946AD - 1947AD famine across the forty-five regions.

Conclusion

Across the twenty-seven years between the 1926AD census and the death of Stalin in March 1953AD, the population of the forty-five regions (n=45) increased by +14% overall from 145,07M to 165,35M, yet this net gain masks two demographic troughs in 1933AD (149,93M) and 1945AD (142,62M) alongside a wholesale geographic redistribution from the famine- and war-struck western and southern grain belts toward the Urals, Siberia and the Far North. By March 1953AD, the 165,35M population across the Russian SFSR (114,37M including Kaliningrad and Karelia), the Ukrainian SSR (35,48M including Crimea), the Byelorussian SSR (7,2M), the Baltic SSRs (5,78M) and the Moldavian SSR (2,52M) established the demographic baseline for the post-Stalin Soviet Union.

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